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CJP team attacked over attempt to inspect school

Team attempted to inspect a govt. primary school in a Rajasthan village where classes are being held in a cattle enclosure; CJP blames BJP and threatens agitation if the school is not repaired

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

A team of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activists was allegedly assaulted and chased out of Rampura-Kanwarpura village near Jaipur on Friday, when it attempted to inspect a government school as part of the organisation’s ‘School Thik Karo’ campaign. The vehicles of team members were damaged, and women supporters were allegedly roughed up.

The team, led by party co-convenor Ashutosh Ranka, travelled to the village in the Bagru Assembly constituency to inspect the Government Primary School. However, some villagers had barricaded the road and checked the vehicles entering the area.



CJP workers being confronted during their ‘School Thik Karo’ campaign at Bagru village in Jaipur, Rajasthan, on Friday. PTI

When the team of about 40 CJP workers arrived in the village, some people confronted them, raised slogans, and asked them to leave. During a scuffle that followed, the team members were allegedly man-handled and driven out with stone-pelting. The villagers later staged a sit-in

outside the school.

Mr. Ranka said one volunteer had suffered a fractured arm. He alleged that those involved in the attack had been brought in by the ruling BJP. “We had informed the police about our visit... The police were aware of stone-pelting but did not intervene,” he said.

The school building had earlier been declared unsafe because of its dilapidated condition and was closed. Currently, classes are being held in a cattle enclosure. “We had inspected the school last year as well... It was being run in a buffalo shed even then,” Mr. Ranka said.

The villagers, however, claimed that the funds for school repair work had already been sanctioned.

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke announced that he would arrive in Jaipur and launch an agitation if the school repair work did not begin, and if the BJP members who allegedly attacked the volunteers were not arrested within the next 48 hours.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

After Cong. stir, FIR over pellet gun use registered

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Following a seven-hour *dharna* (sit-in) by the Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, outside the office of New Delhi’s Deputy Commissioner of Police, police registered an FIR against the use of pellet guns on protesters during the July 20 march to Parliament.

Mr. Gandhi held the *dharna* after Sahil Lochab, a 19-year-old who lost vision in one eye after being hit by pellets during the protest, said the police had refused to register an FIR on his complaint.

The Congress leader, accompanied by his sister and Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other senior Congress leaders, ended the sit-in after the police relented.

Mr. Lochab said he had written a seven-page complaint as soon as he was discharged from the hospi-



Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi protest inside Parliament Street Police Station in New Delhi on Friday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

tal and went to various police stations. “But the police did not acknowledge my complaint. I have been trying to get an FIR registered first at Connaught Place, then at Mandir Marg, Sansad Marg and even the Crime Branch but to no avail,” he said.

A student of the School of Open Learning at the University of Delhi, Mr. Lochab had said in his complaint that he received multiple pellet injuries on his chest, back, arms, and face. He was seriously in-

jured in his right eye; pellets had entered his body, and several of them could not be taken out. “Doctors have told me that the possibility of my eyesight coming back is less than one per cent,” he wrote.

The FIR was registered in the evening under Sections 118(1) (voluntarily causing hurt using dangerous weapons) and 125 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

₹4,895-cr. FDI projects come in under new framework

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Centre received a total of 29 foreign direct investment (FDI) projects worth ₹4,895.65 crore under a revised framework allowing firms with up to 10% Chinese ownership to invest via the automatic route, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry said on Friday.

The proposals were submitted by entities based in Mauritius, the United States, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Singapore, Luxembourg, and the Cayman Islands.

The investments cover sectors such as information technology, artificial intelligence, information and communication, manufacturing, transport, pharmaceuticals, and data centres.

FULL REPORT ON
» **PAGE 13**

IN BRIEF

National Song calls for cultural nationalism: Shah

KOLKATA
Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Friday said that by creating *Vande Mataram*, which was later declared the National Song, Bankim Chandra Chatterjee had established that independent India must embrace cultural nationalism. » **Page 9**

Centre declines nod for Revanth Reddy’s U.S. trip

HYDERABAD
The Centre has denied permission to Telangana CM A. Revanth Reddy to visit the U.S. as part of his Telangana Rising initiative, prompting him to cut short his London tour and return to Hyderabad on Sunday. » **Page 6**

Champat Rai says Nripendra Misra was principal authority on Ram Temple construction

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Former Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust (SRJTKT) general secretary and senior Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader Champat Rai, in an article released on August 18, said Ram Temple construction committee chairman Nripendra Misra exercised near-complete control over the temple’s construction and “considered himself the principal authority on all decisions”.

In the nine-page Hindi article, shared in the VHP media group, he claimed that no work on the Ram Temple was undertaken without Mr. Misra’s appro-



val and that decisions taken without his involvement were rejected.

“Shri Nripendra Misra brought several people of his choice into the temple construction committee to assist him. One of them visited Ayodhya only once or twice during the previous six years, while another

was consulted on security-related matters. A third member, Shri Anoop Mittal, former chairman of NBCC, regularly attended the committee meetings,” Mr. Rai wrote. He added that the committee’s meetings were generally held every month and, for some time, once every 15 days.

Mr. Rai also credited Mr. Misra with playing a key role in overcoming hurdles during the project. “Whenever any obstacle came, he requested the most capable persons in the concerned field and called them to Ayodhya,” he wrote.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

From above



A panoramic view of Visakhapatnam’s coastline from the Dolphin’s Nose Lighthouse on Friday. The lighthouse, operated by the Directorate of Lighthouses and Lightships, is open to visitors from 3 p.m. to 5 p.m. daily, offering views of the city, harbour and Bay of Bengal. K.R. DEEPAK

A LEGACY OF ROLES

Sowcar Janaki dies at 94

STATES » PAGE 6



MEDAL ASSURED

Gayatri and Treesa enter the semifinal

SPORT » PAGE 17

Sugar price hike: Odisha, M.P., Punjab hit hardest; keeping close watch, taking measures to stabilise rates, says Centre

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

As sugar prices rose by ₹10 to ₹18 in about 18 States and Union Territories over the past year, the Union government on Friday said it was closely monitoring the situation and had taken steps to stabilise prices.

On Friday, Odisha registered the highest price for sugar at ₹64.72 per kg, which was ₹17.80 higher than on the same date in 2025, followed by Madhya Pradesh and Punjab.

Consumers in Assam, Delhi, Goa, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Meghalaya, Punjab, Tripura and West Bengal also paid over ₹60 per kg for sugar on Friday.



The national average price of sugar was ₹58.23 on Friday.

The national average price was ₹58.23.

Compared with the same date last month, Madhya Pradesh witnessed an increase of ₹15.70 per kg, followed by Punjab, where the increase was ₹14.67 per kg of sugar. Compared to Friday of last week, Madhya Pradesh

saw the sharpest increase of ₹11.82, followed by Odisha, where the hike was ₹10.67.

The Union Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution stated in a release that sugar prices had increased in recent weeks, from ₹48.18 per kg on July 20 to ₹55.70 per kg on August 20.

‘Not linked to ethanol’
“The government has taken a series of measures to ensure adequate availability of sugar and stable prices for consumers,” it stated, maintaining that the rise in sugar prices could not be attributed to ethanol. “It is incorrect to attribute the recent increase in

sugar prices to the diversion of sugar for ethanol production. In fact, the share of sugar diverted for ethanol has declined from around 12% in 2022-23 to around 9% in 2025-26. Moreover, nearly three-fourths of the ethanol produced in the country now comes from grains, particularly maize,” said the government.

It added that the latest increase in sugar prices was due to a combination of factors, including lower-than-expected domestic production, increased demand ahead of the festive season, weather-related damage to the sugarcane crop, tightening global sugar supplies and hoarding

by some sections of the industry.

Global phenomenon
It said sugar prices were rising globally too, maintaining that the diversion of excess sugar towards ethanol had improved the financial health of sugar mills. It said a stock limit of 400 tonnes had been imposed on sugar dealers across the country from August 1 to November 30.

“From September 1, bulk consumers will not be permitted to hold sugar stocks exceeding 15 days of consumption,” stated the official release.

‘ETHANOL POLICY TO BLAME’
» **PAGE 11**

CJI-led Bench lauds scrapped MGNREGA as a ‘good scheme’

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A three-judge Bench of the Supreme Court, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, on Friday praised the repealed Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) while hearing a plea, which sought directions for the government to pay delayed wages under the MGNREGA, along with compensation, and to elevate the statutory guarantee of rural work to the status of a fundamental right.

DETAILS ON
» **PAGE 10**

INBRIEF



HC rejects jockey association’s plea against Race Club eviction

The Delhi High Court on Friday dismissed a petition by the Jockey Association of India challenging the eviction order against the Delhi Race Club from its 53-acre premises in Lutyens’ Delhi. Justice Harish Vaidyanathan Shankar held that the plea was not maintainable as the Delhi Race Club, the principal party, had already challenged the order. The Centre opposed the petition, stating that the association was not a party to the lease agreement. The association argued that the eviction would affect jockeys, trainers and stable staff and disrupt racing activities. It said no alternative facility had been provided and questioned the Centre’s claim that the land was required for a “public purpose”.

Patient’s attendants attack GTB Hospital doctors, staff

Attendants of a road accident victim allegedly attacked doctors and other hospital staff, damaged hospital property and smashed window panes at the newly shifted emergency facility of Guru Teg Bahadur (GTB) Hospital in the early hours of Thursday, the medical facility stated in a release. The patient, Pawan, who had been referred from Lok Nayak Hospital on August 19 with an internal brain injury following a road accident, deteriorated while being resuscitated, after which his attendants created a ruckus, attacking doctors, nurses and other staff with broken glass and knives, it added. Senior hospital officials reviewed security arrangements and sought the registration of an FIR. PTI

Nadda reviews preparedness, calls for robust surveillance as H1N1 cases rise in Delhi

Union Health Minister underscores need for public awareness and preventive health practices as city reports 114 fresh cases; no shortage of beds, doctors or essential medical supplies: Delhi govt.

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda on Friday reviewed the H1N1 influenza preparedness across the country, with particular focus on the national capital. Delhi Health Minister Pan-kaj Kumar Singh also attended the meeting.

‘Monitor trends’

Mr. Nadda stressed the need for continued vigilance, robust surveillance and proactive preparedness, along with close monitoring of influenza trends.

The number of H1N1 cases in the city has risen to 1,777, with 114 fresh cases reported on Thursday, according to data released by the Delhi government on Friday. No fatalities have been reported so far, an official said, adding that there is no immediate cause for concern.

According to information released by the Union Health Ministry, the preparedness of healthcare facilities in Delhi, including the availability of hospital beds, critical care facilities and other essential sup-



Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda reviewing H1N1 influenza preparedness during a meeting in New Delhi on Friday. PTI

plies, was reviewed.

Mr. Nadda also underscored the importance of public awareness and preventive health practices, including respiratory and hand hygiene, and advised people with persistent or severe respiratory symptoms, breathing difficulty or other warning signs to seek medical advice promptly.

Regular reviews

A bulletin issued by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta’s Office stated that the mission director of the Delhi State Health Mission was holding daily review meetings with all Chief District Medical Officers to continuous-

ly monitor the situation.

The H1N1 subtype is predominant this year, whereas H3N2 was the predominant subtype last year, the bulletin added.

“According to doctors, H1N1 can cause sudden fever, dry cough, body aches, headache, sore throat, chills and fatigue. In some cases, patients may develop breathing difficulties and low oxygen levels,” the Ms. Gupta’s office stated in an official release.

It added that the impact of seasonal influenza could be mitigated through simple public health measures, including following respiratory etiquette such as covering one’s mouth

and nose while coughing or sneezing and avoiding spitting in public places.

Mr. Singh said there is no shortage of beds, doctors, medicines or essential medical equipment in the Capital, adding that the patient tally is being monitored and hospital arrangements are being strengthened based on requirements.

Spike in fever cases: AAP

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Friday expressed concern over the “alarmingly high” number of swine flu cases, saying the government should proactively spread public awareness to curb infections.

“Across Delhi, an alarmingly high number of people, especially school-going children, are suffering from high-grade fever, cough and flu-like symptoms. Some say it’s H1N1,” AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj stated in an X post. “I don’t see serious efforts by the government in this regard,” he alleged, asserting that the government should spread awareness and ensure the availability of medicines at hospitals and dispensaries.

(With inputs from PTI)



The structure was being razed illegally; the contractor and the owners are being questioned, said the police. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

One killed, 3 injured as building collapses during demolition

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A three-storey building collapsed during demolition work in Regarpura in Karol Bagh on Friday, killing a labourer and injuring three others, the police said, adding that one of the injured is in critical condition.

The incident occurred around 11.15 a.m. at a residential building on Pyare Lal Road.

According to preliminary findings, the building was being demolished by a private contractor engaged by its owners. The police said no permission had been obtained from the concerned agency.

The police have detained the building owners and contractor for questioning. Further legal action will follow after verification of the facts, said a senior officer.

The Delhi Fire Services

(DFS) received a call about the collapse at 11.49 a.m., following which it rushed a team to the spot.

Those trapped were pulled from under the debris. One of the labourers, Sheikh Shamshad, succumbed to his injuries.

Injuries to head, limbs

An injured identified as Mohammad Ayub sustained a head injury and a fracture on his right hand. He was referred to Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital. His condition remains critical. Sheikh Saidul sustained limb injuries and is undergoing treatment at Jeevan Mala Hospital while Rafik-Ul, the third injured, suffered minor injuries and was later discharged, the police said.

A DFS officer said the ground floor and two upper floors collapsed during the demolition work, trapping the labourers.

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• NOIDA, Nirula's Sec-2, Near Metro Station, Sec-15, Noida, UP

• LAJPAT NAGAR, 49, Main Ring Road, Adj. Haldi Ram, Near Moolchand Crossing

Govt. of Jharkhand

Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board

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Advt. No. :-JCECEB/48 /26 - 64 Ranchi/Dated: 20/08/2026

Notice regarding 1st Round of Online Counselling for MDS All India & NRI Quota Seats of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Farathiya, Garhwa on the basis of NEET MDS-2026 Result

Online Application Forms are invited from qualified eligible candidates of NEET MDS-2026 examination for the preparation of all India merit list. Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare Department, Ranchi has earmarked 60% Seats of MDS for All India Quota and 15% for NRI Supported Candidates out of 16 of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Farathiya, Garhwa.

In pursuance of the above, online application forms are invited by the Board from NEET (MDS) – 2026 qualified eligible candidates who fulfill the following eligibility criteria:-

Educational Criteria:-

a) The Candidates who have passed the BDS degree course from a university or college approved by the Dental Council of India (DCI).

b) Candidate must have Permanent/Temporary Registration from DCI or Jharkhand State Medical Council. Even in case of Temporary Registration, they will be eligible for admission in MDS course, but it will be mandatory for them to get Permanent Registration by the last date of admission otherwise the admission of the candidate will be cancelled.

c) The candidate must have completed the Rotating Internship by 31 May, 2026.

d) Interested candidates are requested to fill the Application Form Online on Board's website <http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in> by Clicking on "Click here for All Online Application Submission –JCECEB 2026" tab by following the given directions as per the schedule given below :-

A. Schedule for 1st Round of Online Counselling for NEET (MDS)-2026 Course

Sl. No.	Activity	Schedule Date
1.	Online Application Form filling & Certificates/Documents Uploading	22.08.2026 to 25.08.2026
2.	Publication of Provisional State Merit List for 1 st Round of Online Counselling	27.08.2026
3.	Online Registration & Choice Filling for Seat Allotment	28.08.2026 to 30.08.2026
4.	Issue of Provisional Seat Allotment Letter	01.09.2026
5.	Certificates /Documents verification and admission in the concerned Institute	02.09.2026 to 05.09.2026

B. Counselling will be held as per the guidelines issued by MCC/DCI New Delhi. In case of any change in guidelines, counselling dates as well as other terms & conditions will be notified accordingly.

C. It is mandatory for the candidate to upload Score Card of MDS-2026.

Applicable Fees:-

Applicants have to pay Application/Registration, Counselling Fee and Security Deposit through Payment Gateway by Credit Card/Debit Card/Net Banking as given below:-

(a) Application/Registration Fee:-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	₹ 4000 /-
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of Jharkhand state	₹ 500 /-
3.	Divyang candidate	-

(b) Counselling Fee:-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	₹ 2000 /-
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of Jharkhand state	₹ 1200 /-

(c) Security Deposit:-

Sl. No.	Institution	Security Deposit
1.	GOVERNMENT	30,000/- (UR/EWS) 15,000/- (ST/SC/OBC/PWD)
2.	Private	Medical College-2 LacDental College-4 Lac
3.	Both (Government/Private)	Medical College-2 LacDental College-1 Lac
4.	Stray/Mopup	50,000/-

6. (a) Security Money will be forfeited if admission is not taken after seat allotment in Second Round and next Round of Counselling. Apart from this, Security Money will not be returned even in case of cancellation of admission in case of giving wrong information by the candidate at the time of registration and not presenting the required original certificates at the time of admission.

(b) The Security Money will be refunded if the candidates have taken valid admission and no seat is allotted after any stage of Counselling.

(c) Security Money deposited by the candidates at the time of counselling, will be refunded to the candidate and/or the institute within three months after the end of last round of online counselling.

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CM

YK

FYUP graduates with 7.5 CGPA now eligible for direct PhD: DU

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi University (DU) on Friday announced that students from the first batch of the Four-Year Undergraduate Programme (FYUP) who graduated with a minimum CGPA of 7.5 can apply directly for PhD programmes without pursuing a master’s degree.

For students belonging to the Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe categories, the minimum requirement is a CGPA of 7.

The university stated that the provision would be available only for the 2026-27 academic session as a special measure for the first batch of FYUP students.

Special measure

“In the interest of the first batch of students who have completed the FYUP in 2026, the university will

admit students who have 7.5 CGPA (7 CGPA for SC/ST) and above in the FYUP directly to the PhD programme only for the academic session 2026-27 as a special measure as per rules of the university,” the university stated in a release.

The decision comes amid concerns over limited seats in the one-year postgraduate programmes for FYUP graduates.

The first FYUP batch began in 2022-23 with 75,948 students. Over 40,000 exited after three years, while 35,943 continued into the fourth year. Of these, 12,111 applied for the one-year postgraduate programme.

Students had earlier protested against the inadequate number of postgraduate seats offered. Following the protests, the university increased the number to 5,857 across 46 programmes.

Over 2,000 industrial units inspected for pollution control norms; 33 face closure orders

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi government inspected 2,011 industrial units between January and July this year, imposing environmental compensation on 44 units and issuing closure orders against 33 for non-compliance, according to the government.

The inspections were part of a campaign led by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta to monitor industrial pollution and ensure compliance.

Ms. Gupta said that 106 units were found to be non-compliant with prescribed environmental standards, while 78 were operating without a valid Consent to Operate (CTO) from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC).

“Providing clean air to

CM Rekha Gupta said strict action will continue against polluting units. FILE PHOTO

Delhi is a priority for our government. We will extend all possible support to industries that comply with environmental regulations, but there will be no laxity towards units that violate the rules or pollute Delhi’s air,” Ms. Gupta said.

She added that action was being taken against other units under relevant environmental laws, with the government’s focus on controlling pollution at its source rather than merely

penalising violators. “Our message is clear, industries that comply with environmental regulations will receive support and facilitation, but strict action will continue against those that pollute Delhi’s air,” she stated. The government also urged citizens to report pollution-related violations through the Green Delhi app or the Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s 311 app.

Construction ban

Ms. Gupta said construction will be banned in Delhi from December 10 to January 20 to curb winter pollution. She said sites measuring more than 500 square metres would be monitored through the Dust Portal and AI-enabled cameras, with real-time alerts sent to the Control and Command Centre. Violations will attract notices and fines.

DDA to enforce land pooling via town planning schemes

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Areas in Delhi could soon be notified under town planning schemes (TPS), requiring landowners to mandatorily pool their land for planned development, including roads, parks and other public infrastructure. The provision, introduced in the Master Plan for Delhi-2047, which was notified on Thursday, is aimed at taking forward the land pooling policy in areas where owners have not been able to voluntarily come together, a senior Delhi Development Authority (DDA) official said on Friday.

According to the official, the new model will not replace the existing consortium model for land pool-

ing. Instead, it will give the DDA another way to assemble land in smaller pockets of less than 20 hectares that do not form a consortium.

“Under the master plan, roads of 30 metres and wider in high-density corridors and low-density areas will be constructed under the TPS,” the official said. “If a landowner has one acre and 50% of it is required for a road, the floor area ratio permissible on

one acre can be allowed on the remaining portion,” he said. The land pooling policy covers 105 villages in six zones, and the authority estimates the areas could eventually unlock land for about 12 lakh houses. Once an area is notified as a TPS – TPS-1, TPS-2 and so on – landowners’ participation will be mandatory, the official said.

“Their plots will be reconstituted after portions are set aside for roads, open spaces, social infrastructure and other services. The features of the land pooling policy concerning outcomes and benefits to landowners will remain the same across the models,” he added.

The move comes as the DDA tries to make its land pooling policy work at

scale. The authority stopped acquiring land in 2013 and introduced land pooling under the Master Plan for Delhi-2021, shifting to a system in which private landowners pool their land while the DDA assumes an active role as a facilitator rather than a developer.

“Farmers coming together on their own to form a consortium can develop the land on a 60:40 basis. But if participation is voluntary, there will always be some who do not join. Then it becomes difficult to develop the entire area or carry out public infrastructure work,” the official said.

Third mode in works

A third mode of land pooling is also being worked

out. “The detailed regulations for the entire land pooling policy will come in the next few months with the approval of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. They will explain TPS and the other modes as well,” the official said.

The DDA has examined models followed in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Mumbai and Ahmedabad. It is also processing amendments to the DD Act to provide for mandatory pooling through TPS.

“The ultimate benefit to the farmer and the DDA will be the same. The difference is in how the land is brought together,” the official said, adding that the revenue outcome for the authority would also remain the same across the models.

CM YK

Rajasthan govt. tables UCC Bill in Assembly amid Cong. protests

Press Trust of India
JAIPUR



Security beefed up at the Rajasthan Assembly in Jaipur. FILE PHOTO

The Rajasthan Assembly was adjourned twice on Friday amid continued sloganeering by Congress MLAs over the alleged denial of entry to them through the regular gate of the House on the opening day of the Monsoon Session before the proceedings were finally adjourned *sine die*.

The Question Hour could not be held due to the disruption, while proceedings during the Zero Hour were also affected.

As soon as the House assembled, Leader of Opposition Tika Ram Jolly raised the issue of Congress legislators allegedly being prevented from entering the Assembly building through the regular entrance on Thursday. He demanded an inquiry into the incident and said the Opposition wanted to raise issues concerning the people in the House.

Speaker Vasudev Devnani, however, did not allow him to raise the matter during the Question Hour.

Following this, Congress MLAs stood up and started raising slogans. Members from the Treasury Benches also objected to the Opposition's conduct. Mr. Devnani repeatedly appealed to the members to maintain order. However, with the disruption persisting, he adjourned the House until noon, and again till 1 p.m. When the House met for the third time, Congress MLAs continued raising slogans.

The House, however, proceeded with several legislative businesses. The government introduced the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill in the Assembly.

6 injured in knife attacks on passers-by in Mangolpuri

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

At least six persons were injured after a group of men allegedly attacked passers-by with knives in the Mangolpuri area here on Friday evening, police said.

The attacks were reported from three lanes in Mangolpuri's L Block.

The injured were taken

to the Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital, with two of them later referred to the Safdarjung Hospital, police said. Police are scanning CCTV footage to identify and apprehend the accused.

A preliminary probe suggests that an old enmity might have triggered the attack, while some suspects are believed to be juveniles, police said.

Assam-Meghalaya traffic hit as cabbies continue blockade

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI



Transporters blocking the Assam-Meghalaya border at Jorabat on Friday. PTI

Cab operators in Assam continued to block the entry of Meghalaya-registered vehicles on the Guwahati-Shillong road for the second successive day on Friday, following the August 19 attacks on Assam-registered vehicles during a Khasi Students' Union (KSU) rally in Shillong.

The blockade at Jorabat and Khanapara, entry points to Shillong, disrupted the movement of passengers and goods between the two States. The situation remained tense despite the Chief Ministers of the two States calling for peace and restraint.

"We will not relent unless the Meghalaya government punishes all those who damaged vehicles and assaulted people during a rally. We also want the Meghalaya government to pay for the damages and ensure such hooliganism does not happen again," an Assam State Drivers' Association member said.

Similarly, members of Meghalaya taxi operators' associations and other organisations prevented Assam-registered vehicles from entering the State at Byrnihat. Among those who were turned back was a legislator from southern Assam's Barak Valley.

The Assam government has activated WhatsApp (9181014888) and landline (03612381511) helpline numbers for people stranded in Meghalaya and facing difficulties there.

Meanwhile, Meghalaya issued an advisory on Friday, listing alternative routes for people travelling to or from Guwahati.

Timings	DELHI
SATURDAY, AUG. 22	
RISE 05:54 SET 18:54	
RISE 15:01 SET 00:14	
SUNDAY, AUG. 23	
RISE 05:55 SET 18:53	
RISE 15:51 SET 01:05	
MONDAY, AUG. 24	
RISE 05:55 SET 18:52	
RISE 16:35 SET 02:00	

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	36	28
Safdarjang	36	28
Palam	35	26

Delhi Palam Today
35°C The weather will be warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower with gusty winds to occur.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
35°C The weather will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower to occur.

THE HINDU
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SWIFT

Sixty-one people have been affected so far due to consumption of spurious liquor in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district, with eight deaths confirmed and 10 patients being critical, officials said Friday. As many as 25 people who consumed the liquor containing methanol, a highly toxic substance, are still undergoing treatment, the district administration said. Police have arrested 13 of the 21 accused named in the FIR registered at Vartej police station in connection with the hooch tragedy. Gujarat is a 'dry' State where the manufacture, sale and consumption of alcohol are banned. PTI

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activist Vivek Tiwari's indefinite hunger strike entered its seventh day on Friday, demanding pothole-free roads in Maharashtra's Palghar district. The protest was launched to highlight the inadequate and poor infrastructure in the Vasai-Virar region. A CJP delegation also visited Mr. Tiwari and backed the protest. Nitin Dighe, CJP national coordinator, who also took care of Sonam Wangchuk's health during his indefinite hunger strike, visited Mr. Tiwari and said, "We are taking care of his health and observing his vitals as it is the first concern. His blood sugar levels have been dropping and needs to be addressed."

The Congress has opened formal alliance talks with the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and the Revolutionary Goans Party (RGP) to build a united front ahead of the 2027 Goa Assembly election.

Talking to reporters, State Congress president Girish Chodankar confirmed positive preliminary discussions with AAP and RGP leaders, but noted that detailed seat-sharing negotiations will begin once the Goa Forward Party lifts its temporary suspension on alliance talks.

As the principal Opposition party, the Congress has taken the initiative to bring like-minded parties together to fight the upcoming Assembly poll as a united front, Mr. Chodankar said.

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) in Odisha has planned a grand tribute to Swami Laxmanananda Saraswati, the Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader who was killed by left-wing extremists in 2008 after being accused of promoting religious hatred. His assassination triggered one of the worst episodes of communal violence in Kandhamal district.

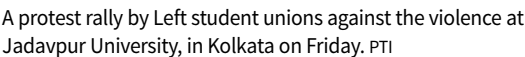
To mark the birth centenary of Saraswati, Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi on Friday announced to develop Gurujang, former leader's birthplace a 'heritage village' and transform the Gurujang gram panchayat as a 'model panchayat'.

merely an individual, but a great ideal, a remarkable institution and a radiant guide of Sanatan dharma. In the modern age, he renounced worldly comforts and devoted his life to serving the tribal communities, living in the dense forests of Kandhamal. He established the Chakapada and Jalespata ashrams and a Kanya Gurukul there, providing tribal girls with Sanskrit education and values and helping them become self-reliant," said Mr. Majhi attending the birth centenary celebrations.

West Bengal Minister and senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader Dilip Ghosh on Friday threatened to carry out 'surgical strikes' on Jadavpur University if 'anti-national' slogans are raised.

‘TMC to blame’
 “The Trinamool had allowed them to perpetuate. Our people had carried out surgical strikes there. The SFI office was demolished. If anti-national movements are seen there again or slogans are raised, there will be surgical strikes again,” said Mr. Ghosh, Minister-in-Charge of Panchayat and Rural Development.

The remarks came a day after supporters of RSS-linked Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) and Left-backed student unions, including the Students Federation of India (SFI), held multiple rallies and got into a face-off on the Jadavpur University campus.



Clashes were reported inside the university premises on Wednesday evening when ABVP supporters allegedly forced themselves inside the campus. Meanwhile, the BJP

Meanwhile, the BJP struck different notes on the Jadavpur University violence. Minister of Finance Swapan Dasgupta said that student agitation should not be hijacked by people who are professional politicians and added that he thinks “half the problem stems when this happens”.

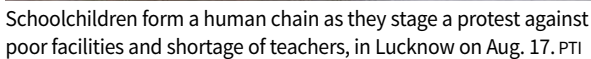
“And I believe this has happened in Jadavpur University with the result that everything has gone very murky,” the Minister said.

On Friday, an FIR was registered at the Jadavpur police station on the complaint of the Vice-Chancellor of the university regarding the violence in the campus.

Clash at Presidency

Ripples of Jadavpur University violence reached other educational institutions in the State as supporters of

Amid a series of protests by schoolchildren over inadequate infrastructure and a shortage of teaching staff in Uttar Pradesh, Opposition parties in the State on Friday said comprehensive education reforms and an overhaul of existing facilities are the need of the hour. The Opposition also expressed dissatisfaction with the 14-point checklist issued by the Education Department on Thursday for nearly 40,000 basic and secondary schools, calling it "mere eyewash".



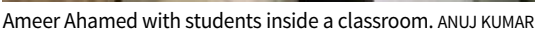
staged a protest demanding better infrastructure.

'Deeper anxiety'
Criticising the Bharatiya Janata Party-led State government, Ghazipur MP and senior Samajwadi Party (SP) leader Afzal Ansari said, "The Afklist is an attempt at hiding systematic failure; an eyewash. The truth is that the BJP government has let Uttar Pradesh and the country down by benefiting a few individuals."

After initial hesitation, young Hafiz Abdus Samad allows entry into his world and whispers, "I want to join IFS, Indian Foreign Service."

The 14-year-old from Mewat wants to change the perception of his backward region in Haryana. "I want to serve in the UAE and tell the world that in India one can follow his or her religion without discrimination."

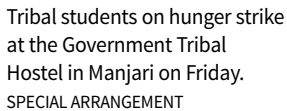
Samad is among the hundreds of Huffaz at Vision International Academy learning that modern science and mathematics are not at odds with Islamic teaching. Huffaz are students of madrasas who have memorised the Arabic verses of the Koran by heart. But these teenagers don't just have the spiritual



capital. Clad in kurta pyjamas with skull caps decorating their little heads, they express themselves in broken English, can reflect on the physics behind a pendulum, know a thing or two about Premchand's stories and can appreciate Rohit Sharma's casual aggression and Babar Azam's cover drives.

A brainchild of philanthropist Ameer Ahamed, the boarding school is tucked into the heart of

Two tribal students were hospitalised as an indefinite hunger strike by students at the Government Tribal Hostel in the Manjari area of Maharashtra's Pune district entered its ninth day on Friday.



hul Dhanwe, 24, were admitted to Sassoon Hospital after experiencing breathing difficulties and dehydration and are currently undergoing treatment, protester Navnath More said. The other protesters on hunger strike are Nikita Metkar, 22, Shweta Girnak, 26, and Sharad Thokal.

The students are demanding the withdrawal of the government resolution issued on August 5, which imposes age restrictions and conditions relating to academic breaks that they consider unreasonable.

The students are opposing a provision that prohibits hostel residents from taking up employment. Protest leader Sharad Thokal said, "Why stop stu-

dents from working part-time? Financial empowerment is necessary for some students. These students are over 18 years of age.”

The students have demanded the scrapping of the guideline reserving 70% of hostel vacancies for students from the same district, compensation of ₹1 crore each for the families of three girls who died of snakebites at a tribal residential school in Gadchiroli, and registration of criminal cases for culpable homicide against officials held responsible for the deaths. They have also sought the implementation of recruitment for 12,500 tribal posts, the reinstatement and permanent appointment of PESA employees who were relieved from service.

tion sector to match international standards while keeping employability in mind," said Mr. Ansari.

The Congress alleged that the Education Department's announcement was a ploy to divert attention from the closure of thousands of schools across the State.

“Over 25,000 schools have been closed in U.P. over the last nine years. The BJP government has completely failed to provide quality education. Hence, students are forced to hit the streets,” said senior U.P. Congress leader Anil Yadav. He added, “I believe the BJP intentionally doesn’t want quality standards to rise, as it feels that educated people will challenge its Hinduva-centric authoritarian regime.”

The 14-point checklist includes regular inspections of facilities such as drinking water and electricity supply.

and the basics of comparative religion to build understanding and respect for other faiths. And for one day of the week, we ask them to dress up in a pant-shirt."

Wasi Miyan Khan, a senior teacher at the school, has a PhD from Jamia Millia and has taken theology lessons at Deoband school. "My goal is to use their strong memory to clear board exams by inculcating curiosity and inquisitiveness."

‘Intense scrutiny’
After Mr. Siddiqui’s arrest, Mr. Ahamed says he faced intensive scrutiny from the authorities, but eventually everything was found “clear and transparent.” “I am following PM Narendra Modi’s mantra of national service where a Muslim has Koran in one hand and computer in other.”

Over the past nine years, Uttar Pradesh has transformed its agricultural landscape through progressive policies, direct support to farmers, expanded irrigation, technology adoption and market reforms, building resilience, raising incomes and securing a prosperous future for millions.



A sample of a Farmer ID card, which includes a photo, a QR code, and fields for Name, Age, Gender, and Address. The card number 123456789012 is visible at the bottom.

Period	Share of Population Aged 65 and Over
2016-17	8%
2025-26	18%



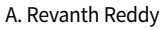
ri-markets &
ness
ous,
ulture ecosystem

A small green plant with several leaves is growing out of a mound of dark brown soil. The plant is positioned in the center of the slide, with its roots embedded in the soil. The background is a light, neutral color.

“

**Our farmers are not just food providers
they are the architects of Uttar Pradesh's prosperity.** - **Yogi Adityanath**, Chief Minister, U.P.

EMPOWERING FARMERS • MODERNISING AGRICULTURE • BUILDING A PROSPEROUS UTTAR PRADESH



The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

"I have always believed we should all think beyond politics and elections when it comes to nation building and the future of the youth," he said.

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI

The song “Maalai Pozhuthin Mayakkathile Naan Kanavu Kanden Thozhi” from the film *Bhagyalaksh-*

Even though many fe-



Kannada milestones

In Kannada industry, she debuted with *Devakannika* (1953). Her long on-screen

Ms. Janaki essayed prominent characters in the 1960s and 70s. Panthulu's *School Master*, an acclaimed social drama, is another noted work. Her next Kannada project was also a milestone movie. B.S. Ranga's *Mahishasura* *Mardini* (1959) is considered the first major pan-Indian movie. The movie, starring Dr. Rajkumar, Uday Kumar and Narasimharaju, was dubbed into seven languages follow-

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

While he got relief in a previous case of detention on August 4, he was again detained during Operation Mukta on August 8. “I consistently pleaded with the police, showing a copy of the High Court order

Originally from Nadia district in West Bengal and living in Bengaluru for the last 12 years with his wife and daughter, Mr. Rafikul says he has been targeted by the city police. The claims took shape after so-

“Every time someone asks us where we are from, our fear cannot be described. Once you say West Bengal and if you’re a Muslim, the instant reply is, ‘Go to Bangladesh’. What does it take to prove that we are Indians?” he said.

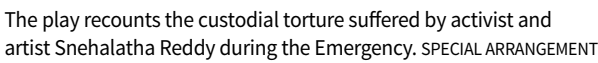
The Tamil Nadu government has assured Keralam that it will review the restrictions imposed on the transportation of construction materials, including rough stones and aggregates, to the State. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Joseph Vijay gave the assurance to Keralam Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan on the sidelines of the Southern Zonal Council meeting on Thursday. Tamil Nadu had earlier decided to regulate the transportation of construction materials to ensure adequate supplies within the State.

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) is learnt to have recently sought sanction for prosecution from Karnataka Governor Thawarchand Gehlot against Planning and Statistics Minister B. Nagendra, even as the Opposition BJP and JD(S) continued to disrupt legislature proceedings for the fifth consecutive day on Friday seeking ouster of the Minister. The Central probe agency, which investigated the Valmiki Corporation scam, has already filed chargesheets in three FIRs in which Mr. Nagendra has been named.

The Sri Sathya Sai district administration in Andhra Pradesh has busted an inter-State racket that allegedly trafficked impoverished tribal workers from Maharashtra to the district, confined them in charcoal kilns and subjected them to bonded labour. District task force teams conducted surprise raids and rescued 40 workers, including two minors, who were allegedly trafficked from Koshimbale village in Nizampur taluka of Maharashtra's Raigad district. A team conducted a raid at Talamarla village in Kothacheruvu mandal and rescued four workers.

Mini Muringatheri
THRISSUR

Critics have accused the production of obscenity, objecting to certain intense and realistic scenes and costume choices. The cast, cultural figures and DYFI leaders, however, have defended the play *MISA* (Maintenance of Internal Security Act) as a powerful portrayal of “state terror and political repression”.



Staged by Chilanka Floating Theatre, Kozhikode, at the heart of the play is Snehalatha Reddy – actor, producer, writer and activist who stood against the oppression during Emergency imposed in 1975.

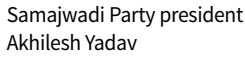
“Those who look at only some scenes from the play through the lens of morality are trying to forget the severe persecution suffered by people during the Emergency,” said DYFI State secretary V.K. Sanoj. The police arrested Sne-

A.D. Rangarajan
KADAPA

The premises of Y.S. Bhaskar Reddy, father of Kadapa MP Y.S. Avinash

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

“Talking about Brahmins and promising respect to the community is a good beginning, but Akhilesh has a long road to cover to secure the community’s support,” said Shivesh Trivedi, a Basti-based activist associated with the Akhilesh Bharatiya Brahmin Mahasabha. He added, “Brahmins have so far supported the BJP, the Congress and



The SP has one Brahmin MP in the Lok Sabha (Sanatan Pandey from Ballia) and a few legislators from the community in the U.P. Assembly, including Mata Prasad Pandey, the Leader of the Opposition.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Sources said the witness told the court on Thursday, that supporters of the accused had made threatening calls to her after her previous deposition.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Dr. Singh said India had chosen 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Coop-

eration and Sustainability' as the theme of its BRICS Presidency in 2026. The theme reflected the conviction that science and technology must serve humanity by fostering equitable partnerships among nations.

Dr. Singh said India remained committed to advancing an inclusive and human-centric approach to science and innovation. He referred to India's initiatives, including the National Quantum Mission, BioE3 Policy, National Geospatial Policy and the Digital Public Infrastructure ecosystem, which reflected an approach where innovation improves people's lives and economic conditions.

Teachers on Census work deemed to be on school duty: HC

Press Trust of India
KOLKATA

The Calcutta High Court on Friday said teachers deputed on Census work would be deemed to be on school duty and said they cannot refuse the assignment as it is in the national interest.

Disposing of pleas over teachers being assigned

population survey work, it said if the director of Census Operations and the Charge Officer intend to avail their services, the date, time and place must be specified to the head of their institution. Justice Krishna Rao said, “Census is required to be done in national interest and nobody can avoid such work”.

Boy falls off hill after row over phone; parents die trying to save him

Yohaana Varghese
MUMBAI

A 18-year-old boy and his parents died after falling from a cliff at Khavdya Hill in Tisgaon in Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar district of Maharashtra on Friday, following a dispute over buying a new phone, according to officials.

The incident occurred around 10 a.m. after the youth, Kunal Murlidhar Chandvade, allegedly went to the cliff following a disagreement with his father, Murlidhar Chandvade, 48, over his demand for a new phone. The parents also died in the incident while attempting to save their son. A case has been registered under Section 194 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023.

According to District Collector Vinay Gowda, “The village sarpanch, and other villagers tried to pacify the boy, but he did not listen. The father eventually climbed up the hill to bring his son away from the edge,” Mr. Gowda said. However, the boy fell from the cliff and, while holding on to his father's hand, pulled him down with him. When the boy's mother tried to rescue them, she too slipped and fell.

(Those in distress can contact Tele MANAS at 14416 to seek help)

48 teachers to be honoured by President on Sept. 5

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

President of India, Droupadi Murmu, will confer the National Teachers Awards on 48 school teachers at Vignyan Bhawan, New Delhi on September 5. The purpose of the award is to celebrate the unique contribution of some of the finest teachers in the country, the Ministry of Education said in a statement.

This year, a total of 48 school teachers have been selected through a three-stage selection process at the district, State and national levels. The selected school teachers are from 27 States, seven Union Territories and six organisations of the central government.

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**Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department**
SECTION 1
Superintending Engineer, 11th Circle HPPWD., Rampur Bsr.
(Name of authority inviting bids)
NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

1. The Superintending Engineer, 11th Circle, HPPWD., Rampur Bsr on behalf of Government invites the percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system, for construction of roads under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana-IV, Batch-I of 2025-26 for each of the following works including their maintenance for five years from the eligible and approved contractors registered with registered with HPPWD/ CPWD/ P&T, Railways/ other State Govts /Central Govt agencies. Non-registered bidders may submit bids; however, the successful bidders must get registered in appropriate class with appropriate authorities before signing the contract.

Sr. No	Distt.	Package No.	Name of the work	Estimated Cost (Rs. Lakh) excluding GST	Total Cost (Rs. Lakh) including GST	Period of completion (in days)	Bid Security (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of Bid Form (Non refundable) (In Rs.)	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1.	Shimla	HP-09-756	C/O Link road Shelag to Devjubar road Km 0/000 to 2/025	231.55	14.80	246.35	540	4.93	7000

2. Date of release of Invitation for Bids through e-procurement: **24.08.2026.**

3. **Cost of Bid Form:** As per amount mentioned in the table against each package/job (non-refundable) through online mode only on website pmgsytendershp.gov.in in favour of Executive Engineer, Kumarsain, HPPWD., Kumarsain.

4. **Availability of Bid Document and mode of submission:** The bid document is available online and bid should be submitted online on website www.pmgsytenders.gov.in. The bidder would be required to register in the web-site which is free of cost. For submission of bids, the bidder is required to have valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities (CA). Aspiring bidders who have not obtained the user ID and password for participating in e- tendering in PMGSY may obtain the same from the website: www.pmgsytenders.gov.in

Digital signature is mandatory to participate in the e-tendering. Bidders already possessing the valid digital signature issued from authorized CAs can use the same in this tender.

**Non-registered bidders may submit bids; however, the successful bidders must get registered in appropriate class with appropriate authorities before signing the contract.*

5. **Submission of Original Documents:** The bidders are required to submit (a) Receipt of the cost of bid document submitted online and (b) Receipt of bid security deposited online and (c) original affidavit regarding correctness of information furnished bid document as per provisions of Clause 4.4B(a)(ii) of ITB with Superintending Engineer, 11th Circle HPPWD., Rampur Bsr on a date not later than three working days after the opening of technical qualification part of the Bid, either by registered post or by hand.

6. Last Date/ Time for receipt of bids through e-tendering: **31.08.2026 upto 1500 hours.**

7. The site for the work is available.

8. Only online submission of bids is permitted, therefore; bids must be submitted online on website www.pmgsytenders.gov.in. The technical qualification part of the bids will be opened online at 1530 hours (time) on **31.08.2026** (date) by the authorized officers. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day at the same time.

9. The bidder is not required to quote his rate for routine maintenance. The rates to be paid for routine maintenance are indicated in the Bill of Quantities. Further, the payment for routine maintenance to the contractor shall be regulated based on his performance of maintenance activities.

10. The bids for the work shall remain valid for acceptance for a period not less than ninety days after the deadline date for bid submission.

11. Bidders may bid for any one or more of the works mentioned in the Table above. To qualify for a package of contracts made up of this and other contracts for which bids are invited in the same NIT, the bidder must demonstrate having experience and resources sufficient to meet the aggregate of the qualifying criteria for the individual contracts.

12. Other details can be seen in the bidding documents. The Employer shall not be held liable for any delays due to system failure beyond its control. Even though the system will attempt to notify the bidders of any bid updates, the Employer shall not be liable for any information not received by the bidder. It is the bidders' responsibility to verify the website for the latest information related to the tender.

The undersigned has right to extend or cancel the tender without declaring any reason.

Signature and Designation of the Authority Inviting Bids for and on behalf of Governor of H.P.

Superintending Engineer
11th Circle HPPWD.,
Rampur Bushahr,
Distt. Shimla (HP) Tel: 01782-233044
Email ID:- hp-shi1@nic.in

HP / 2832/26-27 **HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK**

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कार्यालय प्राचार्य, शासकीय विधि महाविद्यालय नर्मदापुरम (म.प्र.)

क्रमांक : 807/स्था./2026 नर्मदापुरम, दिनांक: 20.08.2026

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

इस महाविद्यालय में शैक्षणिक सत्र 2026-27 हेतु योजना क्रमांक-5551 “आधुनिक तकनीक से शिक्षण” योजना अंतर्गत क्रय हेतु GeM Portal पर निविदा आमंत्रित की गई है। निविदा की शर्तें एवं विस्तृत विवरण GeM Portal पर उपलब्ध है।

क्र.	निविदा क्रमांक	प्रकाशन एवं प्रारंभ तिथि	समाप्ति दिनांक	निविदा शर्तें
01	Bid No.-GEM/2026/B/7936970	19/08/2026	09/09/2026	Available on Gem Portal

म.प्र. माध्यम/127684/2026 प्राचार्य

**BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION**
Office of the Executive Engineer, Dasarahalli Division, Zone-2, MEI Layout, Hesaraghatta Main Road, Bagalagunte, T. Dasarahalli, Bengaluru- 560 073.

No: BNCC-Z2/EE/DD/TEND/12/2026-27 Date:21.08.2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER
(Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System)

The Executive Engineer, Dasarahalli Division, Zone-2 invites tenders from registered contractors of Bengaluru North City Corporation, or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD/ Railways / MES or any State Government Organizations for the work detailed in the table below.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1.	Providing Thermoplastic Painting for Rumbler strips, Lane Marking, Junction Markings, different types of sign boards, pillion signals and Kerb stones, HRPC and other safety furniture's as per Traffic police requests in Dasarahalli Division. Approximate value of work: Rs. 202.47 Lakhs. EMD : Rs. 3,03,800/- Category : Others.

1)Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> 2) Pre-bid Meeting: **07.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.** 3) Last Date for uploading the Filled proposals: **15.09.2026 up to 16:00 hrs.** 4) Opening of technical bids: **16.09.2026 after 16:00 hrs.** 5) Opening of financial bids: **After Approval of Technical bids.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Executive Engineer
Dasarahalli Division, Zone-2.

PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION UNIT(PIU)-USDMA
Uttarakhand Disaster Preparedness & Resilience Project (U-PPREPARE)
5th Floor, USDMA Building, 36, IT Park, Sahasradhara Road, DEHRADUN
Website: www.u-prepare.com; Email id: procurement.uprep@gmail.com

Ref. No. : 397/A-11/IT Equipment's/U-PPREPARE/2025 Date: 21/08/2026

Request for Quotations

The Government of India has received financing from the World Bank towards the cost of the Uttarakhand Disaster Preparedness & Resilience Project (UPREPARE). PIU-USDMA, an implementing agency of U-PPREPARE intends to apply part of the proceeds for the procurement of the following good(s):-

S. No.	Package No.	Name of Package	Method of Procurement
1	A-11/IT Equipment's / U-PPREPARE/2025	Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of an Active LED Video Wall along with a Video Wall Control Processor for SEOC	Request for Quotation (RFQ)

Note:-1. Any corrigendum / addendum to the above package shall be uploaded on the website www.uktenders.gov.in

2. For any clarification or information, bidders may contact- procurement.uprep@gmail.com

The quotation document in English may be downloaded by interested eligible bidders from the website <https://uktenders.gov.in> from 22/08/2026.

Program Manager

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Estates Department, BSD,
Corporate Headquarters, Srinagar,
M. A. Road Srinagar, 190 001 J&K

Online Request of Tender (e-NIT)
For Devri Stone Tiling of Existing Concrete Footpaths at CHQ by way of Civil works

Tender Notice along with Complete Tender document outlining the minimum requirements can be downloaded from and BIDs can be submitted on the Banks' e-Tendering Portal <https://jkbank.abcpocure.com> w.e.f. August 19, 2026, 13.00 Hrs. Tender Document can also be downloaded from Bank's Official Website <https://jkb.bank.in/tenderNotice>. Last date for submission of Bids is September 02, 2026, 17.00 Hrs. **e-NIT Ref.No JKBE&ED/CHQ/Concrete-Footpath/2026-1858**
Dated:19-08-2026

Registered office : Corporate Headquarters, M.A.Road, Srinagar 190001, Kashmir, India
CIN: L65101JK19385GCC000048; T : +91 (0)194 2481 930-35; F : +91 (0)194 248 1928; E : info@jkbmail.com; W : <https://jkb.bank.in>

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER**
SRI VIJAYA PURAM SOUTH DIVISION
APWD, SRI VIJAYA PURAM

No. DB-e-TENDER/SVPSPD/2026-27/2060 Dated: 01.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

The Executive Engineer, Sri Vijaya Puram South Division, APWD, Sri Vijaya Puram, South Andaman on behalf of President of India, invites online Percentage rate composite bids on **ENGINEERING, PROCUREMENT AND CONSTRUCTION (EPC Mode-I)** for the work mentioned in table below through e-Procurement from eligible and experienced Contractors.

NIT No: 196/Tech/SE(P)/CE/2026-27

Name of work: Construction of New Medical College at Port Blair Sub work : Construction of Basic Science Block for Medical College at Dudhline, Port Blair (Block-B & C-Para-Clinical) including Development of site on EPC Mode –I (Design and Build Basis).

Estimated Cost: ₹67,72,75,455/-

Earnest Money: ₹77,72,755/-

Time of completion: Twenty Four (24) Months

Last date and time of submission of Bid: 28.08.2026 15:00 Hrs.

Last date and time of opening of Bid: 28.08.2026 15:30 Hrs.

The tender forms and other details can be obtained from the website <https://eprocure.andamannicobar.gov.in/nicgep/app>. Tender ID No. 2026_APWD_24057_1



GROUND ZERO



A farmer sits in his dry paddy field at Vilakudi near Thiruthuraiipoondi in Tiruvavur district of Tamil Nadu. R. VENGADESH

A dry spell along the Cauvery river

A weak monsoon has left farmers on both sides of the Cauvery struggling with dwindling water supplies. In Karnataka, farmers are worried about irrigation even as the State faces pressure to release water to Tamil Nadu, where large tracts of paddy fields remain barren. The competing demands have sharpened tensions between the two States. **Laiqh A. Khan** and **T. Ramakrishnan** report on the plight of farmers

Marilingaiah, a farmer from Karnataka’s Kuntanahalli village in Maddur taluk of Mandya district, has raised a nursery of paddy seedlings on his two-acre plot. He is waiting for water to reach his fields, which lie at the tail end of the Visvesvaraya irrigation canal system. The canal draws water from the Krishna Raja Sagara (KRS) reservoir, located across the Cauvery river near Mysuru.

Worried, he says, “If water does not flow into the fields in the next 10 days, I will not only have to give up hopes of sowing paddy, but also lose the ₹8,000 I have spent on raising the nursery.”

Marilingaiah knows that adequate rainfall, along with canal water, is essential for the paddy to survive. Yet, he is among the many farmers in Karnataka’s Cauvery basin who have defied official advice against sowing water-intensive crops such as paddy and sugarcane this season, amid a predicted deficient monsoon and inadequate inflows into the basin’s reservoirs.

The optimism of the farmers was fuelled by a brief revival of the monsoon in the first week of August, when the water level in the 124.8-foot KRS reservoir rose from 93-94 ft to over 100 ft within a few days, before stagnating at 109 ft.

While farmers like Marilingaiah have chosen to trust nature instead of switching to semi-dry crops such as ragi, pulses, or oilseeds, others are waiting for a clearer picture to emerge. D.K. Ramu of Kodihalli village in Maddur taluk and Raju of Siddapura village in Srirangapatna taluk are among them. “If there is a promise of water in the next few days, I will sow paddy. Otherwise, I will grow ragi,” Ramu says. However, he notes that heavy rain could also damage the ragi crop.

Farmers across Karnataka’s Cauvery basin are facing not only the pressure of a deficient monsoon and uncertainty over the availability of irrigation water, but are also concerned about the need to share the limited Cauvery water with neighbouring Tamil Nadu – a vexed issue that goes back more than 130 years.

Meanwhile, in Tamil Nadu, farmers in the Cauvery delta are facing a water crisis of their own. Low storage at the Mettur dam, Karnataka’s failure to release a sufficient share of the water it received in June and July, and the Tamil Nadu government’s decision not to open the dam for irrigation on the customary date of June 12 have left large tracts of paddy fields barren. The State continues its legal battle with Karnataka to secure its share of the Cauvery water.

Balancing competing water needs

With the monsoon falling short and reservoir levels under pressure, Karnataka has had to balance irrigation needs with drinking water requirements and its obligations under the Cauvery water-sharing arrangement.

On August 19, the Cauvery Irrigation Advisory Committee, a regional body chaired by Karnataka Water Resources Minister N. Cheluvarayaswamy, met in Bengaluru and decided to release canal water in only four rotational cycles during the crop season, instead of continuously. This decision was taken to conserve reservoir storage and



If water does not flow into the fields in the next 7-10 days, I will not only have to give up hopes of sowing paddy, but also lose the ₹8,000 I have already spent on raising the nursery.

MARILINGAIAH
Farmer from Karnataka

to ensure water availability for other needs, including for drinking.

Devaraj, a farmer from Attahalli village near Mysuru, says the plan to release water for about 15 days and then stop it for the next 15 days will not provide enough water for paddy and sugarcane crops. “Farmers will be able to grow only dry crops,” he says.

The State is also under pressure from the Supreme Court and the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) to share the limited water with Tamil Nadu in what is shaping up to be a distress year. This central body was set up in June 2018 by the Union government to handle water-sharing from the Cauvery among Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and Puducherry

On August 11, Karnataka appealed to the CWMA to immediately reduce water releases to Tamil Nadu from 12,000 cusecs (cubic feet per second) per day to 10,000, warning that there will be severe drinking water shortage if more water is released for crops in the Cauvery basin.

With water to be released under the rotational cycle only as long as reservoir levels permit, State Sugarcane Farmers’ Association president Kurub Shanthakumar questions whether the Karnataka government and its legal team were making a strong enough case for farmers and presenting the State’s position before the Cauvery water-sharing bodies – the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee (CWRC) and the CWMA – and the Supreme Court. He says the legal team does not appear to have succeeded in convincing the authorities about the water crisis in Karnataka.

Farmers in Maddur taluk are also bracing for a confrontation with the State government over the proposed diversion of KRS water to the Cauvery Stage VI drinking water project for Bengaluru, which requires an additional 6 TMC (thousand million cubic feet) of water annually. The Cauvery Stage VI drinking water project is a ₹6,939-crore infrastructure initiative approved by the Karnataka government this February to supply 500 MLD (million litres per day) of Cauvery water to roughly 30 lakh residents in Bengaluru as well as the adjoining towns of Bidadi, Hos-

kote, Anekal, Devanahalli, and Nelamangala.

“Is it fair for the government to starve us of water while diverting it to Bengaluru? Shouldn’t it identify other sources of drinking water for the city instead,” asks Mallesh, a Kuntanahalli resident, who is also a journalist.

A season of uncertainty

While farmers at the canal’s tail end bear the brunt of the distress, paddy transplantation is nearly complete in areas closer to the KRS reservoir, such as Karekura and Hosahalli. In a paddy field in Hosahalli, Cheluvuraju says most farmers in the region typically grow two crops a year given the usual availability of water. But his hopes for a second crop this year have dimmed as reserves have depleted. “We are not sure if we will be able to raise the second crop,” he says.

Cheluvuraju adds that he may have to work as a labourer to make ends meet if he is unable to grow the second crop. Most agricultural labourers in the region earn ₹400-500 for a day’s work from 7 a.m. to noon. The deficient monsoon has also cast a shadow over sugarcane fields. Farmers who have already harvested their crops are relieved, but many others are pinning their hopes on rain. Chikkalingaiah, a farmer from Chikkabyadarahalli in Pandavapura taluk, says his sugarcane crop needs another nine months before harvest – and without timely rain, it may not even be fit to use as cattle fodder.

Many farmers have taken not only interest-free short-term loans from primary agricultural co-operative credit societies, but also high-interest loans from microfinance companies. “If we are unable to grow crops, how will we repay our loans,” asks Nagesh, a resident of Chikkanahalli. He believes that the government should waive farmers’ agricultural loans and take steps to stop microfinance companies, notorious for deploying aggressive recovery agents, from harassing borrowers.

Though the despair among farmers over poor rainfall and the release of water to Tamil Nadu is reflected in the occasional protests, staged mostly by farmers’ organisations and pro-Kannada outfits across different parts of the Cauvery basin, these demonstrations, unlike in previous years, have remained muted. Even the Karnataka bandh, called by Kannada activist Vatal Nagaraj on August 13, drew a lukewarm response, barring parts of Maddur taluk.

Sunanda Jayaram, Organising Secretary of the Mandya District Raithara Hitharakashana Samithi, a farmers’ welfare committee, says with regret that farmers, the main stakeholders in the Cauvery water-sharing issue, were not responding to the calls for struggle.

An agriculturalist in Kuntanahalli, however, points to a different reason: ruling Congress leaders, he says, are actively discouraging farmers from taking to the streets, cautioning them against falling into what they call an “Opposition trap” – joining the protests only to later face the hassle of police stations and court appearances.

Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar has chastised activists for staging protests over the Cauvery issue “for the sake of publicity.” In particular, he warned them against wading into the river – a common form of protest – after the Water Resources Department issued a flood alert earlier this month over the release of water from the near-brimming Kabini reservoir.

While acknowledging that Karnataka’s dams were not yet full, Shivakumar vowed to protect the interests of the State’s farmers. But he has also emphasised the need to uphold the law by complying with directions on the release of Cauvery water to Tamil Nadu.

Crisis in the Cauvery delta

“Very bad, very depressing situation” is how Thanga Jayaraman, an agriculturist from Tiruvavur, describes the situation in Tamil Nadu’s Cauvery delta, considered the rice bowl of the State.

“Ordinarily, when water is released from the Mettur dam (built in Salem district in Tamil Nadu

across the Cauvery) on June 12 for irrigation, it reaches our area, about 300 kilometres downstream, by June 23 or 24. But this year, nothing,” says Jayaraman, who taught English at several institutions of higher education before taking up farming after retirement.

A drive of over 200 km from Tiruchi through Thanjavur, Thiruvaiyaru, Tiruvavur, and Mannargudi shows largely barren paddy fields. “You should have come last year. You would have found greenery everywhere,” says A.T.B. Balamurugan, a farmer of Andaankarai, about 15 km from Thiruthuraiipoondi in Thiruvavur district.

Ordinarily, paddy is cultivated across 5.3 lakh acres in the Cauvery delta during the ongoing short-term Kuruvai season, followed by cultivation across 12.9 lakh acres during the longer Samba-Thaladi season, which begins with transplantation in late July or early August and ends with the harvest in mid-January. According to Tamil Nadu government data, the area under paddy cultivation this year has fallen to 4.5 lakh acres.

However, some agriculturists dispute the figure. They say there have been instances of stunted growth and crops showing signs of withering, making the official figure unreliable. The impact, they say, extends beyond the fields.

“Economic activity in the region is getting crippled because of the erosion of livelihood opportunities,” says P.R. Pandian, president of the Tamil Nadu All Farmers Organisations’ Coordination Committee and a resident of Mannargudi. “Shops and other businesses here down their shutters by 7 p.m.”

Located along the eastern coast of the State, the Cauvery delta, spanning districts such as Thanjavur, Tiruvavur, Mayiladuthurai, and Nagapattinam, is characterised by fertile alluvial soil and a tropical climate with the flow of the Cauvery. Its importance can be gauged from the fact that during the procurement year of 2025-26 (September 1, 2025 to July 31, 2026), the region contributed 39.5 lakh tonnes of paddy out of the State-wide procurement of 57.5 lakh tonnes.



Ordinarily, when water is released from the Mettur dam on June 12 for irrigation, it reaches our area by June 23 or 24. But this year, nothing.

THANGA JAYARAMAN
Agriculturist from Tiruvavur

Yet many parts of the zone remain economically backward with a majority of the population depending on agriculture for livelihood, despite climate challenges. Scheduled Castes, who live in large numbers in the region, constitute the dominant segment of landless agricultural labourers.

These are the reasons why successive Tamil Nadu governments have been keen to protect the interests of the Cauvery delta.

Opening the Mettur dam

This year, given the poor forecast for the south-west monsoon, attributed to super El Nino, the government chose not to open the Mettur dam on June 12. “The authorities should not release water from the dam until the water level reaches at least 100 ft,” says Pandian. The level is now about 85 ft, against the full capacity of 120 ft.

The Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal and the Supreme Court have provided for greater share of the river water to be released by Karnataka to Tamil Nadu during the south-west monsoon (123.14 TMC out of the annual quota of 177.25 TMC). This share is mostly meant to support paddy cultivation during the Samba season.

The Samba crop is important not only for food security but is also the mainstay of the delta’s rural economy. Farmers also grow the shorter-duration Kuruvai crop, which can offer higher yields. This crop is largely dependent on groundwater, with farmers using energised pumpsets to irrigate their fields. But declining groundwater levels and salinity are making even this option increasingly difficult.

“My area is located between the Cauvery and one of its branches, the Coleroon (Kollidam). Even there, the water level is going down,” says R. Arivalagan, a farmer from Peramur, about 10 km from Thiruvaiyaru. Submersible pumpsets, once more common in the dry districts of Coimbatore and Dharmapuri, have become commonplace in the delta too. Over-extraction of groundwater has also led to salinity ingress in many areas.

So far, the Tamil Nadu government has not announced when the Mettur dam will be opened, even as it continues its legal battle with Karnataka to secure Tamil Nadu’s share of the Cauvery water. The government has strongly opposed Karnataka’s push to reduce water releases, pressing the Supreme Court to ensure strict adherence to the mandated 12,000 cusecs daily flow.

At the 31st meeting of the Southern Zonal Council held at Mamallapuram and presided over by Union Home Minister Amit Shah, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay said the legitimate rights of lower riparian States and the livelihoods that depend on assured river flows must be fully protected.

Meanwhile, several farmers’ groups have also begun demanding compensation for crop losses. They are unhappy with the crop loan waiver scheme announced by Vijay and are seeking a full, unconditional waiver of up to ₹1 lakh for all farmers who have taken crop loans.

Officials are also hoping that the monsoon will revive, with about a month left in the season. Any compensation for crop losses, meanwhile, will be subject to the Union and State governments’ norms for natural disasters and a survey by the departments concerned.

S. Vivekanandan, a farmer of Vilakudi, is increasingly worried over the prospects of the Samba crop. A senior official says that as the government is closely watching, it will take steps to safeguard the farmers of the Cauvery delta.

laiqh.khan@thehindu.co.in; ramakrishnan.t@thehindu.co.in

From Page One

CJP team attacked over school inspection

The CJP, which cancelled its visit to another government school in a nearby village later in the day, claimed that the confrontation in Rampura-Kanwarpura was pre-planned and had the backing of State Education Minister Madan Dilawar.

Political battlegrounds

The confrontation occurred amid a political row over a recent Education Department order imposing restrictions on the entry of outsiders into government schools and barring photography and videography without the written approval of the heads of institutions. The order was issued after CJP activists joined an agitation by students and villagers at a school in Alwar district on August 14.

The CJP has opposed the restriction and accused the BJP government of attempting to prevent public scrutiny of the condition of government schools. The party's 'School Thik Karo' campaign seeks to assess the condition of school buildings, availability of teachers, and other facilities and academic arrangements.

The incident also spilled over into the Rajasthan Assembly, where the BJP and the Opposition Congress traded allegations. Education Minister Mr. Dilawar later accused the CJP and Congress of attempting to "disrupt education and spoil the atmosphere". He added: "Turning the schools into political battlegrounds is extremely regrettable. Everyone should remain vigilant against the attempts to tarnish the school environment for selfish interests."

The People's Union for Civil Liberties-Rajasthan demanded the immediate arrest of all those accused of attacking the CJP delegation.

After Cong. stir, FIR over pellet gun use registered

On Friday, Mr. Gandhi accompanied Mr. Lochab and his mother first to the Mandir Marg police station and then to the Sansad Marg police station. "Sahil and his family have been moving pillar to post to get his complaint registered. Why is the police refusing to do so?" he told presspersons outside the DCP's office.

"It took them so long to register the FIR. It has been a month since the march when he received his injuries. Even after multiple visits, the police refused to receive the complaint. Who was holding it back? The final order has come from the Union Home Ministry. We all know now that even for an FIR to be registered, the Home Minister has to give an order," Mr. Gandhi said.

Senior Congress leader Salman Khursid said that with the registration of the FIR, which mentions the use of pellet guns, "it is now documented that the police used pellets on July 20, contrary to the police's denial earlier."

The Hindu had reported that an entry in the general diary of Delhi's Sansad Marg police station recorded the use of pellet guns by the Rapid Action Force (RAF), contradicting the Delhi Police's initial denial on use of pellet guns against protesters. The reported use of pellets has raised questions over the police's crowd-control protocols and the circumstances in which force was deployed against demonstrators.

On Thursday, the Supreme Court constituted a five-member High-Powered Enquiry Committee to conduct an independent inquiry into the police action. The committee will examine the use of pellet guns, lathis, tear gas and electric batons.

Misra was key figure in temple construction

Following the Supreme Court's verdict on the Ram Janmabhoomi dispute, the Union government constituted the SRJTKT with 15 trustees. Mr. Rai said Mr. Misra was subsequently appointed as chairman of the committee .

Mr. Rai further detailed that Larsen & Toubro was selected as the construction agency and Tata Consulting Engineers was appointed as the project management consultant, both by Mr. Misra who was informed about the vision of late VHP leader Ashok Singhal, considered the architect of the Ram Janmabhoomi movement. "The temple architect, Ahmedabad-based Shri Chandrakant Bhai Sompura, had been selected by the late Ashok Singhal in 1986 and was retained. For the construction of other buildings, Shri Nripendra Mishra selected Noida-based firm Design Associates, headed by Jai Kakadikar," the article said. According to Mr. Rai, construction of the temple began during the COVID-19 pandemic and was dedicated to society by June 2026. He attributed the achievement to Mr. Misra's efforts.

The article comes after reports that Mr. Rai had received a clean chit from the Special Investigation Team probing alleged embezzlement of donations to the Ram temple.

Congress Rajya Sabha MP Pawan Khera wrote on X that "now Champat Rai has turned around and held Nripendra Misra squarely responsible for how the Ram Mandir construction was handled. It may look like a war of words between two men. But there is more to it than meets the eye. Nripendra Misra is Modi's man. Champat Rai is an RSS man. So this isn't Rai vs. Misra. It is Modi vs. Mohan (RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat) – both desperately trying to wash their hands of the scandal."

Speaking to The Hindu, Mr. Misra said he had read the article in detail and that there was "nothing negative or controversial" in it.

SC lauds scrapped MGNREGA as a 'good, effective scheme'

The scheme was applauded by a three-judge Bench while hearing a petition on delayed wages under the defunct scheme; petition seeks to elevate the right to work as a fundamental right

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Friday praised the repealed Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), calling it a "salutary scheme" that was neither a freebie nor an exploitation of rural workers.

The court's accolade came amid claims by civil rights groups that MGNREGA's successor, the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) or the VB-G RAM G Act, has seen a 50% decline in employment generation, despite an increase in guaranteed work days from 100 to 125 per household annually.

The new law reflects a shift from a demand-driven, rights-based framework to a centrally controlled model. Also, the funding burden on States has increased three-fold, shifting from a 90:10 ratio to 60:40. The "MGNREGA was a good, effective scheme. It did a wonderful job in rural areas and was implemented pan-India. It was neither a freebie nor



MGNREGS labourers working in Tiruvannamalai, Tamil Nadu. The VB-G RAM G is a replacement for MGNREGA. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

exploitation," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, heading a three-judge Bench, orally observed.

Compensation sought

The Bench was hearing a petition filed by activist Aruna Roy seeking directions for the government to pay delayed wages under the MGNREGA, along with compensation.

Advocates Prashant Bhushan, Cheryl D'Souza and Neha Rathi, appearing for Ms. Roy, urged the court to examine whether a law could prescribe minimum wages lower than the

threshold determined by the State concerned.

The petition also sought to elevate the statutory guarantee of rural work to the status of a fundamental right under Article 21 (right to life) of the Constitution.

"The Constitution does not make the right to work a fundamental right. It is more a democratic aspiration under Part IV (Directive Principles of State Policy)... To achieve that aspiration, the state formulates the policy by which work is provided at a graded, compensatory level. Should we treat it on par

with Article 21?" Justice Joymalya Bagchi asked Mr. Bhushan. Mr. Bhushan said the right to lead a dignified life is part of Article 21. "A dignified life requires you to get employment at minimum wages. Anything below minimum wages is forced labour," he submitted.

Justice Bagchi said a minimum wage threshold might risk shrinking employment opportunities, while Chief Justice Kant noted that wages were usually linked to prevalent local conditions.

Justice V. Mohana stated that the issues raised by Mr. Bhushan must be examined afresh in light of the new law, rather than under the MGNREGA. "We have to see fresh details, fresh statistics," Justice Mohana said.

Mr. Bhushan submitted that States were required to provide nearly half the funds under the new law. "The number of employments has come down by half. States have no money," he said.

The court asked him to file a new petition while disposing of the current one.

Trade unions sound the alarm over Supreme Court judgment on the definition of industry

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Left-leaning trade unions have expressed concern over a nine-judge Bench judgment of the Supreme Court that said the definition of industry as per a 1978 judgment of the top court will not be applicable to the recently implemented Industrial Relations Code. They alleged that the latest judgment reflects "a structural tilt" towards managerial interests over the collective rights of workers.

"Justice Nagarathna rightly questioned the necessity of reopening a settled jurisprudence of nearly five decades, particularly when the Industrial Relations Code has already replaced the Industrial Disputes Act," said All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) general se-



Elamaram Kareem

cretary Amarjeet Kaur said. She said the AITUC is deeply concerned that the majority judges have left crucial questions to future litigation instead of confronting the implications of the exclusionary architecture of Section 2(p) of the Industrial Relations Code.

"The Code's exclusions relating to sovereign functions and charitable, social, or philanthropic institutions require strict and constitutionally compati-

ble interpretation. Governmental activity cannot automatically be equated with sovereign function, nor can the institutional label of a charitable organisation by itself erase the industrial character of the work performed by its employees," she said, adding that in an economy increasingly characterised by privatisation, shifting the focus from the substance of work to the institutional status of the employer can operate to the disadvantage of labour.

Centre of Indian Trade Unions (CITU) general secretary Elamaram Kareem said that both the legislature and the judiciary failed to protect the rights of workers as mandated by the Constitution. Trade Union Centre of India (TUCI) president Fredy K. Thazhath said it has slashed labour protections.

Amit Bhelari
RANCHI

The Jharkhand High Court on Friday stayed the notifications for personnel recruited through the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission-Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination and cancelled the appointments of Child Development Project Officers (CDPOs) in the State.

The single Bench of Justice Deepak Roshan stayed the Jharkhand government's decision to cancel the appointments and ordered that the services of the personnel and officials concerned be ensured. "It is made clear that the learned Advocate General is directed to inform the concerned department to allow the petitioners as well as others, who are similarly situated and affected by this notification, to

Two vessels with 22 Indians on board hijacked by pirates

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Two commercial vessels carrying a total of 22 Indian nationals have been hijacked by armed pirates in separate incidents in Yemen and Somalia, a senior Shipping Ministry official said on Friday. The Indian crew members aboard both vessels are safe, as per the latest information.

The Eritrea-flagged oil products tanker, M.T. Sibul, carrying 20 crew members, including 16 Indians, was hijacked in the Gulf of Aden on August 20, about 30 nautical miles off the Yemeni coast, the official said.

A second vessel, the Cameroon-flagged M/V LUTUF, was hijacked on August 17 off Somalia's Puntland coast. The vessel has 10 crew members, including six Indians.

Maritime tracking information indicates that the tanker was approached by an unauthorised vessel before control of the ship was lost. The vessel was seized and subsequently taken toward Somalia's Nugaal coast, according to a Somali official cited by The Associated Press. The M/V LUTUF was carrying Turkish weapons and satellite

The Indian crew members aboard both vessels are safe, as per the latest information

equipment, destined for a Turkish military facility in Mogadishu.

The hijackers – eight armed men suspected of involvement in a previous hijacking – steered the ship toward Nugaal.

The renewed threat adds to security pressures already facing commercial shipping in the Red Sea, Gulf of Aden and wider Indian Ocean region, where vessels have had to contend with attacks linked to the conflict in Yemen.

The two hijackings also come as Indian seafarers face heightened security concerns elsewhere in the region, including the Strait of Hormuz, where tensions involving Iran, Israel and the U.S. have disrupted one of the world's key shipping corridors.

The 2026 BIMCO-ICS Seafarer Workforce Report estimates that India supplies 3,11,936 seafarers, underscoring the country's large exposure to risks affecting merchant crews worldwide.



Members of the JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch and JMM clash at Albert Ekka Chowk, in Ranchi on Friday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

continue their work till disposal of the writ application," the court order said. The court delivered the order while hearing petitions filed by affected persons.

The court had on Thursday stayed the notifications cancelling the 11th and 13th Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) exams. Amid a 25-day agitation over alleged recruitment irregularities, the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM)-led

government on August 18 cancelled 22 exams and ordered a probe into 23 others conducted since 2014.

Meanwhile, clashes took place between JMM workers and protesters of the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch when the latter hit the road to burn the effigies of Chief Minister Hemant Soren and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi. The clashes took place in Giridih and Ranchi.

Protesters gather at Jantar Mantar for overhaul of reservation system

Abhinav Lakshman
NEW DELHI

Thousands of protesters gathered at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Friday under the banner of Reservation Hatao Andolan (RHA), a Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-style Instagram-page led mobilisation of anger against India's reservation policy. The protesters called for an overhaul of the reservation system, demanding that quota in public education and employment be solely based on income rather than socio-economic categories; raised demands such as "one family, one reservation"; and called for the government to roll back UGC's caste-equity rules.

The protests came amidst the BJP-led Union



Protesters demand the rollback of the UGC Equity Regulations (2026) at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Friday. ANI

government reiterating their stance that reservation for socio-economic categories such as SCs, STs, and OBCs is not a poverty alleviation scheme but a scheme meant to ensure representation for marginalised communities. Further, on Thursday, the Centre had told the Su-

preme Court that it was rethinking the 2026 UGC equity regulations.

On Friday morning, the protesters, many of whom were mobilised by different organisations representing people from "general" castes such as Karni Sena and Ranbir Sena, arrived at Jantar Mantar des-

pite public statements from the Delhi Police saying that no permission had been granted. However, the protesters refused to leave and had a stand-off with the security personnel. By evening, the protesters had set up a stage with a banner that read: "Reservation Reform Satyagraha". Around 7:30 p.m., the police announced that the gathering was illegal, and security personnel could be seen putting protesters on buses and taking them away from the site.

Harsh Dubey, the student who started the RHA page, posted on X that a group of protesters were marching towards Raj Ghat. He said protesters will return to Jantar Mantar if the police removed them from there as well.

SC trims law practice requirement to 1 year for judicial service

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Friday upheld its May 2025 judgment mandating legal practice to apply for entry into judicial service, but shortened the required experience from three years to one.

In a majority judgment of 2:1, Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice A.G. Masih said successful applicants with a year's legal practice under their belt could undergo a one-year intensive training at the State judicial academy concerned. This would be followed by a final year of law clerkship with senior judicial officers and High Court judges. The judgment came in lieu of the review petitions filed

against the 2025 verdict. The majority opinion, authored by Chief Justice Kant, noted that a year has already passed since the May 2025 judgment. Candidates who had applied for the post of Civil Judge (Junior Division) in the interregnum would be 'deemed' to have completed the required one year of active legal practice. They would not be asked to furnish 'certificates of proof of practice'. But the rule of one-year prior legal practice would come into force in earnest from April 1, 2027.

Justice Vinod Chandran dissented with the majority view. "Experience at the Bar is essential for students right out of college," Justice Chandran observed.

No change in Tamil Nadu's stand on delimitation, says Minister



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...sugar
...decade
...during



The National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government at the Centre had, on Thursday, allowed duty-free imports of 10 lakh tonne of raw sugar under a Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) till October 31, amid the rising prices of the sweetener in

'National Song shows India must embrace cultural nationalism'



In Siliguri, the Minister inaugurated exhibitions with information on the three criminal laws.

Rahul's sit-in is cheap politics, meant to divert attention from row over *Vande Mataram*: BJP

ly 20 incident and constituted a five-member high-powered committee. "When the country's highest court is investigating the matter, what does Rahul Gandhi seek to prove by sitting outside a police station in front of the cameras? Has the Leader of Opposition lost faith in the

He said the police informed Mr. Gandhi that the Crime Branch was already conducting an intensive probe into all the cases related to July 20 protest and assured him that the incident flagged by him was also being referred to the Crime Branch. "Despite this clarification from the administration, sitting on a protest demonstrates Rahul Gandhi's obstinacy and exposes the Congress party's desperation," said Mr. Nadda.

Former Union Minister and BJP MP Ravi Shankar Prasad criticised Mr. Gandhi for staging a dharna without permission. He said the Congress was indulging in “the politics of anarchy to divert attention after being cornered on the issue of *Vande Mataram*”.

Cong. view on National Song a very serious issue: Rajnath

Rahul Gandhi's politics on the streets signals a new Opposition playbook

Mr. Gandhi, however, sought to shift the political focus from the nationalism debate to the use of pellet guns against protesting students and, crucially, to the role of the Ministry of Home Affairs, which Mr. Shah heads.

A black and white portrait of Dr. S. S. Kulkarni, an elderly man with white hair and glasses, wearing a dark suit, white shirt, and patterned tie. He is looking directly at the camera with a slight smile.

KAMDAR FAMILY WITH STAFF & MANAGEMENT OF
NADI AIRTECHNICS PVT. LTD.
NADI TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION

Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture
Mahadevapura/K R Pura Zone) Bengaluru East City Corporation
Vengaiahna Lake ECO Park, K R Pura, Bangalore -560036

No:SADH(MDP/KRP)TENDER/167/2026-27 Date: 21.08.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT) (Two Cover System)

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)

The Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture (Mahadevapura/ K R Pura) B.E.C.C. (Referred to as Employer in these documents) invites Tenderers to Implement in accordance with KTPP rules 2000, from eligible and experienced Person/Agencies /Firms (Referred to as Tenderers in these documents) registered in Labour department for Maintenance of Parks.

(Standard Tender Document KW-3).

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Beautification, landscape, development, with Borewell digging and other civil works in Venghaiahna Lake ward No.14 Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST) : Rs. 2,00,00,000.00, EMD Amount: Rs.3,00,000.00

Calendar of Events : (1) Date of Notification : **21.08.2026**
 (2) Tender can be downloaded from : **22.08.2026** (3) Last Date for Queries : **22.08.2026** (4) Prebid Meeting : **24.08.2026**.
 (5) Tender Closing Date : **29.08.2026** (6) Technical bid opening date : **01.09.2026** (7) Financially bid opening date :
 After Approval of Technical bid.

**Sd/- Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture
(Mahadevapura/K R Pura Zone), BECC**

PONDICHERRY MUNICIPALITY
PUDUCHERRY

No. 04/PM/EE/DB/2026-27 Dated: 21.08.2026

PRESS NOTICE FOR 'e' TENDER

On behalf of the Pondicherry Municipal Council, e-Tenders are invited from the eligible contractors / firms by the Commissioner, Pondicherry Municipality, Puducherry for the work of **"Development of White Town in Puducherry under the Challenge Based Destination Development Scheme of Government of India. Sub work: Electrical work components in the Development of White Town, Puducherry."** which can be downloaded from the [website www.putenders.gov.in](http://www.putenders.gov.in), only by those contractors who are having valid i-key and Digital Signature Certificate. The detailed procedure is available in the said tender notice.

- i. Availability of NIT from 11.30 A.M. on 28.08.2026 to 4.00 PM on 24.09.2026
Closing time for submission of e-tender at 4.00 P.M on the same day of last date of availability of NIT.
- ii. Pre-bid meeting : 08.09.2026 at 4.00 P.M.
- iii. Date & Time of opening of tender : 24.09.2026 at 4.30 P.M.

Please contact ICICI Bank for e-payment helpdesk guidance in Phone No. 8939202113.
Please contact e-procurement cell, 3rd floor, Chief Secretariat, e-tender helpdesk for guidance in phone No.0413-2220225 & 1800 3070 2232 (Toll free)
mail id: support-eproc.pon.nic.in

Sd./

No. 172/DIP/AD (Press)/ADVT/2026-27

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, DEPARTMENT OF SPACE,
INDIAN SPACE RESEARCH ORGANISATION (ISRO)
CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP
ISRO-TELEMETRY TRACKING & COMMAND NETWORK (ISTRAC)
Plot No.12 & 13, 3rd Main, 2nd Phase, Peenya Industrial
Estate, Bengaluru-560 058. Fax:080-28094180,
Ph:080-280904182, 4541

CORRIGENDUM-I Date:21.08.2026

1. On behalf of the President of India, **item rate E-Tender** is invited from Contractors of appropriate class for the following work.

NIT No.	ISTRAC/CMG/E/CON/E-TN-56/ 2026- 2027 Dated: 23.07.2026
Name of Work	Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Power Fencing System of IDSN Campus, ISTRAC, Byalalu
Estimate cost put to tender	Rs. 132.06 Lakhs
Tender Document details	E-Tender
Period of completion	Eight (08) Months
Period during which the tender document can be downloaded	From 16.00 hrs. on 24.07.2026 to 16.08.2026 till 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 05.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.
Bid clarifications	From 11.00 hrs. on 25.07.2026 to 17.08.2026 till 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 06.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs
Last date of reply to Bid clarification	18.08.2026 up to 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 07.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.
Last date & time of receipt of tenders	19.08.2026 up to 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 08.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.
Due date and time of opening of tenders	21.08.2026 after 11.00 hrs. Extended up to 10.09.2026 after 11.00 hrs.

2. Interested Tenderers may please refer **Detailed Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)** for eligibility criteria and other details in website: www.isro.gov.in and download the tender documents from www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO.

Sd/- Group Head, CMG

Turkiye issues arrest warrant for Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu



Japan protests Russian missile tests off disputed Kuril islands



U.S., South Korea wrap up military drills 6 days earlier than planned



Russian drones kill 14 people at a mall in a central Ukrainian city



Imran Khan shifted back to jail after medical check-up

DUBAI/WASHINGTON

CM
YK



MIKEL ARTETA



ENZO MARESCA



ANDONI IRAOLA



MICHAEL CARRICK



XABI ALONSO

Who will seize control of the post-Pep Premier League era?

With Guardiola abdicating the throne and leaving his kingdom after six top-flight English titles in 10 years, there will be an almighty war of succession. The 2026-27 Premier League season will be the battleground to decide whom the power is transferred to

N. Sudarshan

The 10 years Pep Guardiola spent at Manchester City represent one of the greatest acts of dynasty-building in the sporting universe. Not only did the Catalan coach City to six Premier League titles, five League Cups, three FA Cups, one UEFA Champions League crown and one at the FIFA Club World Cup, he did so by assembling multiple great sides, revolutionising tactics, and constantly reinventing himself.

Dominant reign

Guardiola's six Premier League trophies are second only to Alex Ferguson's 13 at Manchester United, and even in the four years when City did not win the top prize, it stayed in the top three. No other coach won more than one Premier League title during Guardiola's time in England.

When such a king abdicates the throne and leaves his kingdom, as Guardiola did at the end of the 2025-26 campaign, there is bound to be an almighty jostle among those below to be the immediate heir. The 2026-27 Premier League season, which got underway late on Friday (August 21), will be the battleground to decide whom the power is transferred to.

The set-up is conducive for an intriguing competition. City without Guardiola will be one of nine clubs to have new coaches, and two others in Manchester United and Tottenham Hotspur did not have Michael Carrick and Roberto De Zerbi in place at the start of the year.

Mikel Arteta, who secured Arsenal its first English top-flight crown in 22 years, is the most experienced, having been in the job for a little over six years and seven months. Unai Emery, who masterminded Aston Villa's 2025-26 Europa League triumph, is next, with a stint now at

Pep assembled multiple great sides, revolutionised tactics, and constantly reinvented himself

roughly three years and 10 months.

Though Guardiola has exited the scene, his giant shadow still looms. Enzo Maresca, who has replaced the 55-year-old at the Etihad, and Arteta have served as his assistants. Xabi Alonso, installed as Chelsea's new manager, was once Guardiola's midfield marshal at Bayern Munich.

The post-Pep Premier League era will not have a clean break in terms of tactics too, for Guardiola has left a deep imprint, both in terms of the first principles he introduced, and how he evolved and shed his orthodoxies to cater to the League's fast-changing demands.

When he first arrived, Guardiola was a cleric of the possession-heavy school and was canonical in his belief that retaining the ball was the best route to success. So much so that even goalkeepers weren't spared; one of his first decisions at City was to replace Joe Hart, a top-class shot-stopper, with Claudio Bravo, a ball-playing goalie.

And it felt like the league as a whole – with the glorious exception of Jose Mourinho's Manchester United – was trying to inculcate parts of it.

Guardiola then changed tack to embrace high-energy players and those with great individual skills in order to adjust to the breathless, end-to-end football that the likes of Jurgen Klopp (Liverpool) and Mauricio Pochettino (Tottenham) introduced. The controlled aggression of the earlier years made way for a more expressive and expansive style.

Philosophical blasphemy

And in his last four seasons in charge, he played with one of world football's purest strikers in Erling Haaland. For a man who once made Lionel Messi turn out as a False 9, and then won two

Premier League trophies in 2020-21 and 2021-22 with midfielders as top-scorers (Ilkay Gundogan with 13 goals and Kevin de Bruyne 15), to have Haaland score 112 times over four campaigns would have been akin to philosophical blasphemy.

However, football is now more direct and physical than in recent times and it is to Guardiola's credit that he tweaked his methods and put in place a blueprint for success. "You need to adapt, evolve," City's Maresca said recently. "Set-pieces, man to man – it's a little bit the direction where football is going. We managers... it's our duty to find solutions."

Who among Arteta, Carrick, Alonso, Andoni Iraola and Maresca will answer the call? For one, the sight of Arteta, Carrick and Alonso walking briskly up and down the touchline is sure to remind fans of their glory days as players for Arsenal, Manchester United and Liverpool not so long ago. For a certain generation, it will appear like they are reliving a childhood dream.

Arteta has the first-mover advantage, having already won the League and possessing a winning combination. The addition of Bruno Guimaraes from Newcastle for GBP 75 million will reduce the inordinate burden on midfielder Declan Rice. But Arsenal's unsuccessful pursuit of Vinicius Junior suggests that the outfit is mindful of the need of a world-class threat upfront.

Carrick, who took over at Old Trafford after the sacking of Ruben Amorim, had an impressive stint as caretaker manager, winning 12 and drawing three of his 17 matches in 2025-26, and helping United qualify for the Champions League after a two-season hiatus. The question before the astute 45-year-old is whether his United has the quality to sustain simultaneous domestic and continental challenges.

For Alonso, Chelsea is the opportunity to light up an aura that has seemingly dimmed after a failed seven-month stint as Real Madrid's boss. The 44-year-old is known to possess a shrewd tactical brain, and his role in ending Bayern Munich's hegemony in Germany – 11 straight Bundesliga titles from 2012-13 to 2022-23 – by leading a young Bayer Leverkusen side to

The ground is fertile for competition. Who among Arteta, Carrick, Alonso, Iraola and Maresca will answer the call?

its maiden crown is noteworthy. The addition of 24-year-old English attacking midfielder Morgan Rogers for a whopping GBP 117 million shows that he has Chelsea's wholehearted trust.

Andoni Iraola's ascent to the top job at Liverpool after making a mark at Bournemouth is eerily similar to Graham Potter's entry into Chelsea in 2022 after a stellar show at Brighton & Hove Albion. But Potter was dismissed in less than seven months, a fate Iraola will want to avoid.

The 44-year-old is agnostic to any style of play that is not front-footed, a factor that endeared him to the Liverpool hierarchy after a dreary end to Arne Slot's time. Can he manage to keep the club faithful happy without the services of Mohamed Salah, who left after nine glorious years?

Tough act to follow

Maresca's situation at City is comparable to what David Moyes faced at United after the latter succeeded Ferguson in 2013. The Italian's first test will be to not get crushed under the burden of expectations after Guardiola's supremely successful tenure. It helps that City is not known to be trigger-happy, for both Roberto Mancini and Manuel Pellegrini enjoyed tenures lasting three years or more before Guardiola arrived.

Maresca also comes with a certain pedigree, having led Chelsea to FIFA Club World Cup glory in 2025, and has added England midfielder Elliot Anderson for a hefty GBP 116 million fee. But he will have to compete without the talismanic World Cup winner Rodri, who has shifted to Barcelona, and fellow playmaker Bernardo Silva, who has moved to Real Madrid.

Will he be guided by the spirit of Guardiola or will the ghost of Guardiola haunt him?



STACKING UP



ATP Men's Top 15

#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Jannik Sinner	24	13,450	17
2	Carlos Alcaraz	23	8,160	17
3	Alexander Zverev	29	8,090	20
4	Felix Auger-Aliassime	26	4,740	22
5	Novak Djokovic	39	3,670	16
6	Ben Shelton	23	3,760	22
7	Daniil Medvedev	30	3,580	23
8	Alex de Minaur	27	3,560	24
9	Taylor Fritz	28	3,375	22
10	Flavio Cobolli	24	3,330	26
11	Rafael Jodar	19	2,621	24
12	Learner Tien	20	2,545	22
13	Alexander Bublik	29	2,525	26
14	Jiri Lehecka	24	2,470	21
15	Lorenzo Musetti	24	2,415	22

Top Indians ▶



Sumit Nagal
Rank 239 ▼ 4 spots



Manas Dhamne
Rank 368 ▼ 6 spots



F1 Drivers' standings

#	Driver	Team	Points	Wins
1	A.K. Antonelli	Mercedes	219	6
2	L. Hamilton	Ferrari	169	1
3	G. Russell	Mercedes	160	2
4	C. Leclerc	Ferrari	138	1
5	L. Norris	McLaren	128	1
6	M. Verstappen	Red Bull	109	0
7	O. Piastri	McLaren	92	0
8	I. Hadjar	Red Bull	68	0
9	L. Lawson	RB	43	0
10	P. Gasly	Alpine	42	0
11	A. Lindblad	RB	23	0
12	F. Colapinto	Alpine	19	0
13	O. Bearman	Haas	18	0
14	G. Bortoleto	Audi	10	0
15	C. Sainz	Williams	6	0
16	A. Albon	Williams	5	0
17	E. Ocon	Haas	3	0
18	N. Hulkenberg	Audi	2	0
19	F. Alonso	Aston Martin	1	0
20	V. Bottas	Cadillac	0	0
21	S. Perez	Cadillac	0	0
22	L. Stroll	Aston Martin	0	0



A.K. Antonelli



L. Hamilton

F1 Constructors' standings

Pos	Team	Points	Wins
1	Mercedes	379	8
2	Ferrari	307	2
3	McLaren	220	1
4	Red Bull	177	0
5	RB	66	0
6	Alpine	61	0
7	Haas	21	0
8	Audi	12	0
9	Williams	11	0
10	Aston Martin	1	0
11	Cadillac	0	0



Badminton Men's ranking

#	Player	Points	Events
1	Shi Yu Qi	94,255	12
2	Kunlavut Vitidsarn	91,215	16
3	Jonatan Christie	89,231	17
4	Anders Antonsen	87,705	17
5	Christo Popov	87,002	20
6	Chou Tien Chen	84,280	27
7	Victor Lai	76,465	19
8	Lin Chun-Yi	71,274	19
9	Li Shi Feng	70,483	16
10	Alex Lanier	70,215	16
11	Kodai Naraoka	70,030	20
12	Alwi Farhan	69,419	19
13	Loh Kean Yew	66,300	20
14	Lakshya Sen	65,573	21
15	Toma Junior Popov	62,697	20

Top Indians ▶



Lakshya Sen
Rank 14



Ayush Shetty
Rank 22



Test Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Harry Brook	852	898
2	Joe Root	840	932
3	Steve Smith	833	947
4	Travis Head	819	884
5	Temba Bavuma	775	806
6	Kamindu Mendis	744	784
7	Shubman Gill	743	807
8	Rachin Ravindra	740	740
9	Yashasvi Jaiswal	733	858
10	Babar Azam	716	882

Test Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Jasprit Bumrah	870	908
2	Matt Henry	861	870
3	Mitchell Starc	826	852
4	Marco Jansen	825	825
5	Pat Cummins	818	914
6	Scott Boland	820	820
7	Kagiso Rabada	807	902
8	Noman Ali	800	853
9	Josh Hazlewood	795	864
10	Gus Atkinson	729	766

ODI Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Shubman Gill	801	841
2	Daryl Mitchell	794	840
3	Virat Kohli	767	908
4	Rohit Sharma	758	879
5	Ibrahim Zadran	719	756
6	Babar Azam	689	894
7	Joe Root	674	810
8	Shai Hope	673	782
9	Charith Asalanka	659	705
10	Harry Tector	653	730

ODI Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	714	775
2	Abrar Ahmed	675	675
3	Jofra Archer	649	682
4	Keshav Maharaj	645	737
5	Mitchell Santner	644	656
6	Maheesh Theekshana	641	680
7	Adil Rashid	613	631
8	Shaheen Afridi	604	691
9	Mehidy Hasan	602	722
10	Adil Rashid	599	671

T20I Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Ishan Kishan	910	910
2	Sahibzada Farhan	848	848
3	Abhishek Sharma	819	931
4	Phil Salt	799	881
5	Pathum Nissanka	751	796
6	Tilak Varma	750	845
7	Jos Buttler	748	794
8	Harry Brook	734	734
9	Mitchell Marsh	706	706
10	Dewald Brevis	702	738

T20I Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	753	828
2	Abrar Ahmed	736	757
3	Adil Rashid	710	747
4	Adam Zampa	700	746
5	Nathan Ellis	675	678
6	Corbin Bosch	669	745
7	Wanindu Hasaranga	668	809
8	Mujeeb Ur Rahman	663	757
8	Varun Chakravarthy	663	818
10	Mohammad Nawaz	658	672



We will soon know whether Russell has found a way during the summer break to address the pace deficit to his colleague. The title fight could still be between the Mercedes drivers; they have the best package. But the last few races have shown that Ferrari and McLaren are not far off. It is an extra set of variables that the 28-year-old could have done without.

Antonelli's emergence, Hamilton's new lease of life, Russell's burden of expectations, Verstappen's displeasure — a hotly debated set of disruptive regulations has led to a curious first half of 2026. How will these storylines play out after the mid-season break?

The 2026 season of Formula One ushered in some of the most drastic regulatory changes in the sport's history. As teams and drivers still try to get around the new cars, the year's first half has been a mixed bag for on-track action. Nonetheless, there has been enough to keep the fans interested. With the FI carnival reconvening after the summer break in Zandvoort this weekend, *The Hindu* reviews the major themes so far to see what could lie ahead.

Add to it the complex algorithms governing how the battery deploys and harvests energy, and drivers were forced to adapt their driving styles to the car's limitations. In the first few races, this led to cars being passed and then passing back as the battery pack emptied and recharged, resulting in 'yo-yo racing'. The fans were none the wiser, as one couldn't ascertain whether the moves were genuine. It took time for teams to adapt, and a rule tweak in Miami has also helped reduce some of the worst effects of 'yo-yo racing'. Still, on energy-hun-

So when he won the first race in Australia from pole and then dominated the sprint in China, he would have felt that his patience was finally paying

The cart is called a sulky, because — anecdotally — it once was the choice of unsociable people prone to fits of sulking.

Sport

NOT SO SOLID

A lot of the points we thought we would finish, we couldn't: Chirag



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

After we lost the first game, they came back a lot more harder in the second. They were playing a solid game. A lot of moments where we thought we would get a point, we didn't; lot of the points we thought we would finish, we couldn't. They were not just retrieving, they were converting it into offence — Chirag Shetty.

TOUGH LOSS

We could've been tighter from our side: Satwik after exit from Worlds



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

They (Wei Keng Liang & Chang Wang) like to play a faster game. They were quite good in the first four shots. Whoever controlled the first four shots were winning. They were everywhere. Wherever we were hitting, they were just playing their game. We could have been tighter from our side — Satwiksairaj Rankireddy.

LAID LOW

World No. 1 Sinner withdraws from US Open with knee injury



FILE PHOTO

World No. 1 Jannik Sinner confirmed on Friday he will not compete in the US Open because of a right knee injury. Sinner had been working hard to recover but realised that he still needs more time, the Italian said in a statement. Sinner had also pulled out of the US Open warm-up tournaments in Cincinnati and Montreal.

INFORMAL OFFER

Hussey could join England as the Test batting coach



FILE PHOTO

Australian great Mike Hussey could face his own country in the Ashes after saying on Friday he was open to joining England as its Test batting coach. Hussey has had an informal approach from England's new red-ball coach Stephen Fleming, the duo having spent 15 years as teammates and coaches at Chennai Super Kings.

Treesa and Gayatri extend dream run, ensure medal

The unseeded duo stuns World No. 4 Jia and Zhang in the quarterfinals to maintain India's proud record of at least one podium finish in each edition since 2011; Wei-Chang too good for Satwik-Chirag

BADMINTON WORLDS

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

When in doubt, attack. Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand stuck to the mantra regardless of the scoreline and reaped the rewards, assuring themselves of a maiden medal at the badminton World championships here on Friday.

Their 16-21, 21-15, 21-13 victory against the Chinese World No. 4 Jia Yifan & Zhang Shuxian in the quarterfinals at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium came in 70 minutes. It was their third big scalp in as many matches after ousting the World No. 17 and World No. 7 pairs earlier.

In the process, the unseeded, unfancied duo also became the first Indian women's pair to do make it to the Worlds semifinals since Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa's historic bronze in 2011. In fact that medal started India's streak of winning at least one medal in every edition since then.

It would also be the only medal for India this time after two-time bronze medallists Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty lost to the World No. 3 Chinese pair of Wei Keng Liang and Chang Wang 21-18, 21-9 in just 35 minutes.

Ranked 39th, Treesa and Gayatri trailed 6-0 in the opening game before fighting back to close the gap to 9-8.

They eventually lost 21-16 but at no point did it look like they were ready



Making it a habit: Gayatri and Treesa produced an upset win for the third successive match. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

to give up.

Gayatri being quick and busy on the net, smashed cross-court winners and constantly set Treesa up for the winners.

The two went from 7-10 to 13-10 in the second game and, with nothing to lose, pushed hard.

They cut down the unforced errors and kept it tight, forcing Yifan, a four time World champion and the reigning Olympic champion, to conceding points and took the match into the decider.

Thereafter it was India all the way. Treesa and Gayatri raced to an 11-5 lead before change of ends and closed out the tie 21-13.

Satwik and Chirag, meanwhile, had their chances in the opening game and even led 18-16

before the opponents reeled off five points to win 21-18. The flat drives targeting the Indians' bodies meant Satwik and Chirag were always cramped for space.

Wei and Chang's lightening quick returns, coupled with retrievals from all over the court made it impossible for Satwik and Chiraj to either lift or fall back on their trademark smashes to get points as the Chinese wrapped up the match in quick time.

The results (quarterfinals):

Men: Victor Lai (Can) bt Rasmus Gemke (Den) 21-19, 21-18; Alex Lanier (Fra) bt Kunlavut Vitidsarn (Tha) 19-21, 21-16, 21-16; Kodai Naraoka (Jpn) bt Anders Antonsen (Den) 21-19, 21-15.

Doubles: Wei Keng Liang & Chang Wang (Chn) bt Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty

21-18, 21-9; Kim Won Ho & Seo Seung Jae (Kor) bt Sze Fei Goh & Nur Izzuddin (Mas) 21-16, 21-16; Aaron Chia & Wooli Yik Soh (Mas) bt Ke Yuan Hu & Xiang Yi Lin (Chn) 21-11, 21-17; Jhe-Huei Lee & Po-Hsuan Yang (Tpe) bt Fajar Alfian & Muhammad Shohibul Fikri (Ina) 21-19, 21-16.

Women: An Se-young (Kor) bt Yue Han (Chn) 21-19, 21-12; Pornpawee Chochuwong (Tha) w/o Nozomi Okuhara (Jpn); Akane Yamaguchi (Jpn) bt Michelle Li (Can) 21-17, 21-10; Wang Zhi Yi (Chn) bt Line Christophersen (Den) 21-10, 21-7.

Doubles: Treesa Jolly & Gayatri Gopichand bt Yi Fan Jia & Shu Xian Zhang (Chn) 16-21, 21-15, 21-13; Baek Ha Na & Lee So Hee (Kor) bt Febriana Dwiiputi Kusuma & Meilysa Trias Puspitasari (Mas) 21-11, 21-11; Sheng Shu Liu & Ning Tan (Chn) bt Nga Ting Yeung & Pui Lam Yeung (Tpe) 21-14, 21-17; Yi Jing Li & Xu Min Luo (Chn) bt Rachel Rose & Febi Setianingrum (Ina) 21-13, 21-14.

We won't stop here: Treesa and Gayatri

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

'Keep calm and carry on,' Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand kept telling each other en route a historic quarterfinal win against Jia Yifan and Shuxian Zhang, who have between them clinched five medals at the World championships and two at the Olympics.

It was forgotten the moment Yifan sent the shuttle wide on match point, Gayatri sprawling on the court and Treesa rushing to hug P. Gopi Chand and B. Sumeeth Reddy in the coaches' corner. They broke down, took a long break before returning to



Ready for more: Gayatri and Treesa. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

answer questions and for once, no one grudged the Indian youngsters.

"It was really difficult with all the emotions and processing what had finally happened but we are ok now," Treesa admitted.

"We are really happy to get into the semifinals and confirm a medal but we are not stopping here. There are matches still to come," she declared.

Next up will be the top-seeded pair of Sheng Shu

Liu and Ning Tan but when asked about the match, Gayatri insisted there would be little change in the mindset.

"We don't want to think too much about the outcome. Today was also a tough match, we knew it would not be easy. We were trailing by a game and even in the second, it was tricky. We told each other to stay calm and will do the same tomorrow, get on court and give our 100 percent and just enjoy," she added.

Gayatri has made no secret of Gopichand the father's strict regimen, but on Friday there were no complaints about Gopichand the coach from either.

A new order in the men's game

Devvanshi Bihani
NEW DELHI

The old order is over and a new order has kicked in. The men's singles semifinal line-up at the World championships has reinforced that.

No one from the world's top-5 made the semifinals here. Instead, Victor Lai of Canada and Alex Lanier of France, the 21-year-olds, will meet in a last-four clash while Taiwan's 36-year-old Chou Tien Chen, who became the oldest medallist in World championships history, faces Japan's Kodai Naraoka in the other.

Lai, already Canada's

first Worlds medallist after last year's breakthrough, is now guaranteed another medal. His quarterfinal against Rasmus Gemke was less about brilliance and more about resilience as he recovered from early deficits in both games. "Each game I play, I learn more," said Victor.

Lanier has already created history. He fought back from 3-11 in the second game to upstage 2023 champion Kunlavut Vitidsarn and became the first Frenchman to win a men's singles medal in the tournament.

"We have the talent and we are also training hard," said Lanier.



Lanier... causing a flutter. AP

The women's draw, on the other hand, offers a mix of familiar names and fresh storylines.

Defending champion An Se-young, returning from a leg injury, stormed into the semifinals without dropping a game. She will meet

Wang Zhiyi, who ended the Korean's 10-match winning streak earlier this season before being beaten by her in the Asian championships final. "The leg is getting better with every match," revealed Se-young.

Akane Yamaguchi won in just 28 minutes against Michelle Li while Thailand's Pornpawee Chochuwong reached her first Worlds semifinal and secured a maiden major medal without playing a shot after Nozomi Okuhara withdrew with a knee injury. "I feel sad more than happy," said Chochuwong, who has endured many injury layoffs herself.

Indian team sweats it out in gruelling conditions

INDIA IN SRI LANKA

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

Surrounded by expansive trees and skyscrapers, the Sinhalese Sports Club (SSC) Ground was like a sauna on Friday. A maximum of 30 degree Celsius belied the actual heat felt in the premises and in this cauldron, the Indian team practised as part of the build-up towards the second Test commencing here on Sunday.

K.L. Rahul and Kuldeep Yadav skipped the pre-game drills, and spin-bowling coach Sairaj Bahutule clarified that the duo was resting. The others did their batting and bowling stints while coach Gautam Gambhir and chief selector Ajit Agarkar watched. Yashasvi Jaiswal, Devdutt Padikkal, Rishabh Pant and Shubman Gill consti-



Stretching every sinew: Pant pulls off an acrobatic take during the training session. PTI

tuted the first quartet that batted.

Gill freed his arms and unleashed big shots while the warning 'watch-out' rang aloud through the ground. Later, the skipper had a chat with Gambhir while Ravindra Jadeja, Dhruv Jurel, Sarfaraz Khan and others batted. Off-spinner Saransh Jain turned his arm over and it remains to

be seen if he will come into contention against a left-hander heavy Sri Lankan batting.

Bowling coach Morne Morkel, always busy at nets, ran in and bowled too.

He had mentioned about coping with the heat in Galle, guess the same challenge awaits his wards in the Sri Lankan capital.

Bahutule supports 'match-winner' Kuldeep

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

Nostalgia may have enveloped Sairaj Bahutule when he entered the Sinhalese Sports Club Ground. He would have remembered his last Test played at the same venue in 2001, a game India lost. The Indian spin-bowling coach, though, quickly immersed himself in the nets here on Friday.

Later, near the dugout, he spoke to the media about the twirly men under his watch. Many questions centred around Kuldeep Yadav, a fine talent but seemingly rusty at the moment. "Kuldeep has been bowling extremely well. It's just that due to the situation that arose in Galle, he had to play a different role. He tried his best to execute that role," Bahutule said.

Getting more technical in his analysis, the Mumbai-kaar added: "We had to see how the trajectory and the speeds work in every



Tough times: Kuldeep struggled in the Galle Test, picking up only one wicket from 25 overs. PTI

session. As the days went by, there was a demand for different types of speeds and trajectories, he definitely was making an effort to bowl that."

Praises Suthar

Turning his eye towards Manav Suthar, Bahutule said: "He is somebody who has bowled a lot in domestic cricket and has done the hard yards. He understands his bowling well.

What we try to do is to see how that awareness of bowling gets better in different conditions, on different pitches, and against different batters. He is very accurate and his trajectories are getting better. He puts in a lot on the ball, the revolutions are good and he is somebody who is like a banker for us."

Bahutule also spoke about the essential nature of ideal preparation: "It's

very difficult for a player sometimes to adjust to different formats. But I think what we did coming early on this tour was, you know in that warm-up game and in the open net sessions, we trained well and got to understand the conditions and could adapt to it. The amount of cricket being played is quite a bit but our job as coaches is to manage their minds and help them adapt."

With Sri Lanka adding more left-handed batters to the squad, the temptation to play off-spinner Saransh Jain is real and Bahutule did not deny that: "There is another day to go before the Test. We will have a look at the pitch and understand what will be the need. Yes, the (left-handed) additions are there in their team. We will definitely consider him (Saransh) once the pitch is completely ready."

The speculation over Kuldeep's berth in the playing XI lingered and when another question was raised, Bahutule said: "He has been a fabulous bowler over the years. Yes, the pitches sometimes are slow and sometimes the ball operates differently for the spinners on certain surfaces. For me, he has always been a match-winner and he definitely is in the scheme of things. But when the ball becomes softer, it becomes even more difficult for a wrist-spinner like him".

In the men's tournament, a solid bowling display helps Riders beat Warriors; Mayank and Ashish take three apiece

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